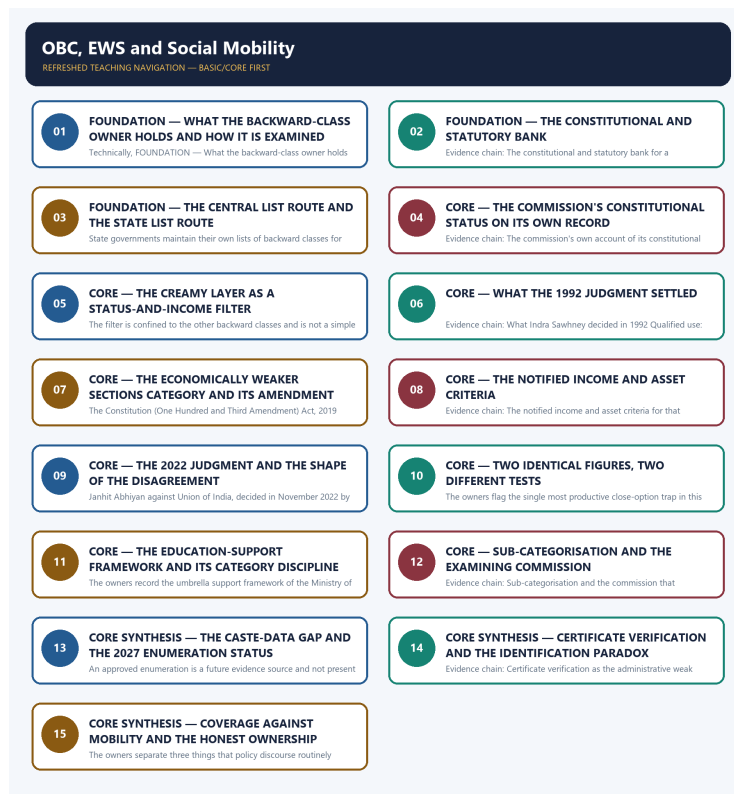


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

OBC, EWS and Social Mobility - Learner-v2 Refreshed

UPSC complete learning session | Foundation to advanced | Concepts, evidence, practice and answer writing



Original deterministic study visual; labels are explanatory, not textual quotations.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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OBC, EWS and Social Mobility - Learner-v2 Complete Learning Session

Authoring-only generation: 2026-09-02. No PDF was rendered and no tracker or index was mutated.

SOURCE, PROGRESSION AND CURRENT-LINKAGE AUDIT

- **Generation date:** 2026-09-02.
- **Repository-first evidence:** the Basic owner is taught first and preserved in full; the Advanced owner is retained only in the optional final teaching block.
- **OCR evidence:** Repository Markdown was primary. The OCR-searchable official General Studies question papers held under books\mains and books\more_previous_papers were read only to confirm the printed wording of routed Mains demands. No official answer key, marking scheme, page precision or unsupported quotation was imported from them.
- **Qdrant:** not used; repository Markdown and available OCR context were sufficient.
- **PYQ integrity:** The audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner for the covered years, and that zero is reported openly rather than concealed or filled with a manufactured demand card. The four audited ledgers consulted are the Mains routing ledgers for 2018 to 2023 and for 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims routing ledgers for 2018 to 2023 and for 2024 to 2025, and neither the Basic owner nor the Advanced owner for this topic carries a generated previous-year integration block, which is itself consistent with that zero. Both owners state independently that there is no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question specifically on the other backward classes or the economically weaker sections in the audited local previous-year texts, and this package adopts exactly that position. The two nearest neighbouring demands are the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from a statutory to a constitutional body, and the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes both to the Polity commissions owner together with the consolidated body-design owner, so no ownership is claimed over either here; reservation doctrine such as the ordinary fifty per cent ceiling and the constitutional validity reasoning for the economic criterion is likewise routed to the Polity special-provisions owner and is cross-linked rather than duplicated. The practice in this package therefore consists of six original Mains questions with model solutions, each written to the repository's examiner-grade standard using the claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification pattern, together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. Each model solution opens with its analytical claim so that the evidence which follows does argumentative rather than decorative work. The locally held OCR-searchable official General Studies papers were read only to confirm that no question on this owner's subject matter is routed here; no question was invented from them, no marking scheme or page precision was imported and no official answer key is claimed for any question anywhere in this package.
- **Live-link boundary:** One live official page was verified for this topic on 2026-09-02. The National Commission for Backward Classes About Us page on the commission's own website, read on that date, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had so far been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 has been repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; that the present eighth commission has been accorded constitutional status and was constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, forming a commission for the socially and educationally backward classes to be known as the National Commission for Backward Classes; and that the commission consists of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure of office were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018. Those statements are used only for what they say, and no case, complaint, recommendation, sitting or list-revision figure is inferred from them. Four further official checks were attempted on the same date, namely a departmental scheme identifier that returned a not-found page, a second departmental scheme identifier that returned the same not-found page, a departmental scheme listing page that returned

navigational content only and a departmental sector-information page that returned navigational content only, so nothing was read or used from them and no secondary summary, coaching site or news report has been treated as an official source. The package therefore relies on that verified page together with the dated official anchors already carried by the repository owners, each cited with its issuing instrument or decision date: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) for special provision and reservation; Article 342A for the Central List, with the President specifying and Parliament alone varying it; Article 338B for the national commission; the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021, the second of which restored the power of States to prepare their own lists for State purposes after the 2021 Maratha reservation reading; the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserting Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) for reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections outside the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes and the other backward classes; the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India of 1992 upholding twenty-seven per cent reservation, mandating the creamy-layer exclusion for the other backward classes only and stating the ordinary fifty per cent ceiling; the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling of eight lakh rupees notified in September 2017, applied over three consecutive years on top of notified parental service and status categories and with salary and agricultural-land income excluded from simple clubbing; the Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019 setting a gross annual family income below eight lakh rupees together with the asset limits of five acres of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft, a residential plot of 100 sq yards in a notified municipality and 200 sq yards elsewhere; the decision in Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India of November 2022 upholding that reservation by a majority of three to two, with the recorded majority reasoning and the recorded dissent; the umbrella education-support framework PM-YASASVI of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students of the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes; the Rohini Commission of 2017 examining sub-categorisation, with implementation recorded as pending as of mid-2026; the last published all-caste census tables of 1931 and the unreleased and unvalidated caste data of the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011; and the recorded status as at 21 July 2026 that the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 to include caste enumeration, that the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise and that the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026. No population share, beneficiary count, certificate count, seat-fill rate, scholarship disbursement, budget or expenditure figure is asserted, no National Family Health Survey, Periodic Labour Force Survey, National Sample Survey, NITI Aayog or Sustainable Development Goal value is asserted, no legal or constitutional provision is invented or upgraded in status, no judicial observation is converted into a binding holding or a legislated rule, no pending report or bill is described as enacted or implemented, and no previous-year question, official answer key or option is asserted or inferred.

- **Fact/inference discipline:** no current-affairs item, PYQ wording, figure or quotation is invented.

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

DEEP-REVIEW LEARNING CONTRACT

Control	Binding rule for this package
Syllabus boundary	Complete Social Justice Basic/Core is answer-complete before optional Advanced depth.
Legal-status boundary	Constitutional value/right, statute, rule, judgment, executive policy, scheme, eligibility rule, implementation and outcome remain distinct.
Rights-holder map	Rights-holder -> entitlement/need -> competent institution/duty-bearer -> accountability forum -> grievance/appeal/remedy.
Delivery chain	Identification -> eligibility -> documentation -> enrolment -> finance -> frontline access -> service/benefit -> portability -> outcome -> audit and correction.
Inclusion method	Intersectional caste, tribe, gender, age, disability, religion, occupation, migration and regional variation is retained without homogenising groups.
Evidence method	Claim -> named India-centric law/institution/scheme/case/dataset -> analysis -> source, reference period, release date, denominator, status and causal qualification.
Dignity and safeguards	Accessibility, privacy, participation, social audit, portability, offline access, due process and protection from stigma or coercion are tested.
Practice contract	Every model has demand decoding, detailed examiner-grade answer, executable timed/compression plan, marks rationale and answer-specific improvement.
Approval	This immutable successor remains approved: false pending explicit approval.

Canonical Basic/Core owner:

upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Social-Justice\basic\09_OBC-EWS-and-Social-Mobility.md **Substantive**

canonical provenance owner: upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Social-Justice\09_OBC-EWS-and-Social-Mobility_Learner-V2-Complete-Topic-Package.md **Optional Advanced owner:**

upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Social-Justice\advanced\09_OBC-EWS-and-Social-Mobility.md **Official**

syllabus mapping: upsc-ai-kit\knowledge\Social-Justice\OFFICIAL-UPSC-SYLLABUS-MAPPING.md

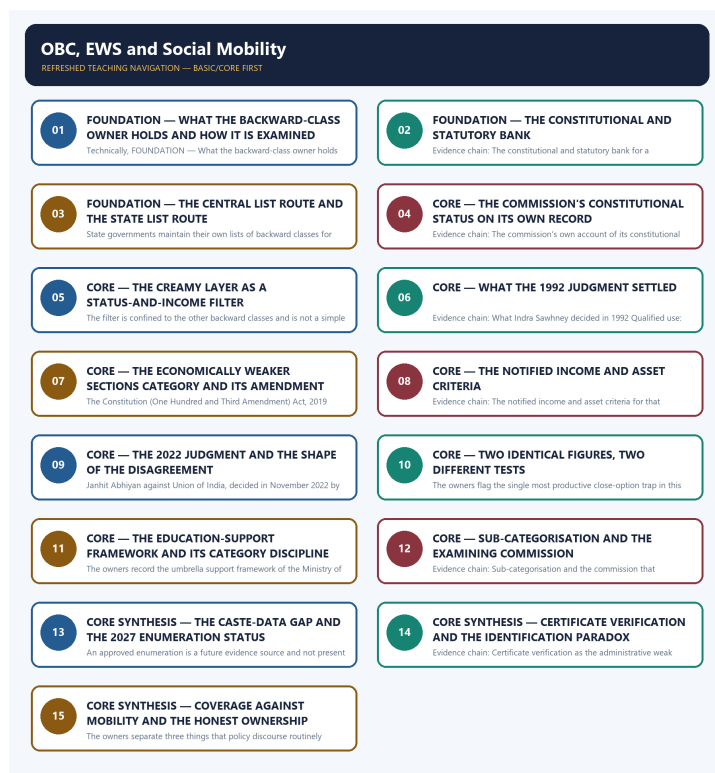
EVIDENCE, PYQ AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROL

- **Prohibition/outcome discipline:** a legal prohibition, reported case, registration, conviction, rehabilitation measure and lived eradication are different claims.
- **Eligibility discipline:** universal, categorical, means-tested, self-declared, notified-list and residence-linked routes require exact scope; coverage never proves adequacy or access.
- **Reservation discipline:** constitutional basis, beneficiary category, competent list, ceiling, creamy-layer rule, EWS route, horizontal/vertical operation and judicial status are qualified separately.
- **Fiscal discipline:** allocation, release, expenditure, unit cost, beneficiary transfer and outcome are not interchangeable.
- **Data discipline:** retain numerator, denominator, unit, geography, reference period, release date, provisional/final status and survey-versus-administrative character.
- **Causal discipline:** headline change, before-after sequence or cross-state correlation does not establish scheme impact without mechanism and counterfactual limits.
- **PYQ discipline:** exact wording is preserved only when verified; routed or reconstructed demands remain labelled and no model is presented as an official UPSC answer.

- **Current-status note, rechecked 2026-09-03:** volatile law, scheme, judgment, list, budget and dataset claims retain issuing authority, date and operative/interim/final status.

Generation-local live/current sources:

- https://www.ncbc.nic.in/User_Panel/UserView.aspx?TypeID=1025 (National Commission for Backward Classes, About Us page, read on 2 September 2026)



Refreshed teaching navigation

Distinct embedded teaching-navigation image. The separate continuous Cārvāka-style flowchart package remains an independent at-a-glance artifact.

SESSION 1 - FOUNDATION - WHAT THE BACKWARD-CLASS OWNER HOLDS AND HOW IT IS EXAMINED

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: What this owner holds and why its previous-year record is stated as zero
Qualified use: Open a backward-class answer by naming the route, identification or distribution, that the question actually tests.

Technical definition: Technically, FOUNDATION - What the backward-class owner holds and how it is examined is analysed by relating FOUNDATION to What the backward-class owner holds, then testing the relationship through how it is examined and Evidence chain.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Prelims: Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to What the backward-class owner holds and how it is examined, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **FOUNDATION**
- **What the backward-class owner holds**
- **how it is examined**
- **Evidence chain**

- **Qualified use**
- **2018-2023**

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define What the backward-class owner holds, connect how it is examined with Evidence chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

WHAT THE BACKWARD-CLASS OWNER HOLDS AND HOW IT IS EXAMINED

01. What this owner holds and why its previous-year record is stated as zero

BOUNDARY -> The two commission demands of 2018 and 2022 are routed to the Polity commissions owner and are not claimed here.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The two commission demands of 2018 and 2022 are routed to the Polity commissions owner and are not claimed here.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to What the backward-class owner holds and how it is examined, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.
- **Mains:** Open a backward-class answer by naming the route, identification or distribution, that the question actually tests.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** What this owner holds and why its previous-year record is stated as zero
- **Qualified use:** Open a backward-class answer by naming the route, identification or distribution, that the question actually tests.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - WHAT THE BACKWARD-CLASS OWNER HOLDS AND HOW IT IS EXAMINED

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - What the backward-class owner holds and how it is examined

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION · What the backward-class owner holds · how it is examined · Evidence chain
· Qualified use · 2018-2023

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: What this owner holds and why its previous-year record is stated as zero Qualified use: Open a backward-class answer by naming the route, identification or distribution, that the question actually tests.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: The two commission demands of 2018 and 2022 are routed to the Polity commissions owner and are not claimed here.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Prelims: Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to What the backward-class owner holds and how it is examined, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.

SESSION 2 - FOUNDATION - THE CONSTITUTIONAL AND STATUTORY BANK

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: The constitutional and statutory bank for a backward-class answer Qualified use: Anchor an affirmative-action answer in the exact article and amendment before any evaluation.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **FOUNDATION**
- **The constitutional**
- **statutory bank**
- **Evidence chain**
- **Qualified use**
- **Article 15**

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define The constitutional, connect statutory bank with Evidence chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

THE CONSTITUTIONAL AND STATUTORY BANK

01. The constitutional and statutory bank for a backward-class answer

BOUNDARY -> The backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are constitutionally distinct enabling provisions.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are constitutionally distinct enabling provisions.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to The constitutional and statutory bank, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.
- **Mains:** Anchor an affirmative-action answer in the exact article and amendment before any evaluation.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** The constitutional and statutory bank for a backward-class answer
- **Qualified use:** Anchor an affirmative-action answer in the exact article and amendment before any evaluation.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - THE CONSTITUTIONAL AND STATUTORY BANK

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - The constitutional and statutory bank

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION · The constitutional · statutory bank · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Article 15

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: The constitutional and statutory bank for a backward-class answer Qualified use: Anchor an affirmative-action answer in the exact article and amendment before any evaluation.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are constitutionally distinct enabling provisions.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the constitutional and statutory bank for a backward-class answer Qualified use.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story.

SESSION 3 - FOUNDATION - THE CENTRAL LIST ROUTE AND THE STATE LIST ROUTE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation.

Technical definition: State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: The Central List route under Article 342A - State lists and the restoration effected by the 105th Amendment
Qualified use: Narrate a list-making controversy in its exact amendment and judgment sequence.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- FOUNDATION
- The Central List route
- the State list route
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Article 342A

How to use them: Frame the answer through FOUNDATION; define The Central List route, connect the State list route with Evidence chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

THE CENTRAL LIST ROUTE AND THE STATE LIST ROUTE

01. The Central List route under Article 342A

|
v

02. State lists and the restoration effected by the 105th Amendment

BOUNDARY -> The 105th Amendment restored a State competence that a judicial reading of the 102nd Amendment had removed.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation.
- State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the

President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The 105th Amendment restored a State competence that a judicial reading of the 102nd Amendment had removed.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to The Central List route and the State list route, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.
- **Mains:** Narrate a list-making controversy in its exact amendment and judgment sequence.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** The Central List route under Article 342A -> State lists and the restoration effected by the 105th Amendment
- **Qualified use:** Narrate a list-making controversy in its exact amendment and judgment sequence.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - FOUNDATION - THE CENTRAL LIST ROUTE AND THE STATE LIST ROUTE

START / CONCEPT: FOUNDATION - The Central List route and the State list route

|

v

EXACT TERMS: FOUNDATION • The Central List route • the State list route • Evidence chain • Qualified use • Article 342A

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the 105th Amendment restored a State competence that a judicial reading of the 102nd...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: The Central List route under Article 342A - State lists and the restoration effected by the 105th Amendment Qualified use: Narrate a list-making controversy in its exact amendment and judgment sequence.

SESSION 4 - CORE - THE COMMISSION'S CONSTITUTIONAL STATUS ON ITS OWN RECORD

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: The commission's own account of its constitutional status
Qualified use: Cite an official institutional statement for exactly what it says and no further.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- The commission's constitutional status on its own record
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Article 338B
- The National Commission
- Backward Classes

How to use them: Frame the answer through The commission's constitutional status on its own record; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with Article 338B to explain the mechanism, and use The National Commission for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

THE COMMISSION'S CONSTITUTIONAL STATUS ON ITS OWN RECORD

01. The commission's own account of its constitutional status

BOUNDARY -> The verified page records constitution, repeal, amendment and composition dates and nothing beyond them.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The verified page records constitution, repeal, amendment and composition dates and nothing beyond them.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to The commission's constitutional status on its own record, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.
- **Mains:** Cite an official institutional statement for exactly what it says and no further.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** The commission's own account of its constitutional status
- **Qualified use:** Cite an official institutional statement for exactly what it says and no further.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - THE COMMISSION'S CONSTITUTIONAL STATUS ON ITS OWN RECORD

START / CONCEPT: CORE - The commission's constitutional status on its own record

|

v

EXACT TERMS: The commission's constitutional status on its own record · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Article 338B · The National Commission · Backward Classes

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: The commission's own account of its constitutional status
Qualified use: Cite an official institutional statement for exactly what it says and no further.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The resulting consequence is that the commission's own account of its constitutional status Qualified use.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the commission's own account of its constitutional status Qualified use.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted.

SESSION 5 - CORE - THE CREAMY LAYER AS A STATUS-AND-INCOME FILTER

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: The creamy layer is a status test before it is an income test - Creamy layer is confined to the other backward classes
Qualified use: State an intra-category equity rule with both of its limbs before criticising it.

Technical definition: The filter is confined to the other backward classes and is not a simple gross-income limit.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: The creamy layer is a status test before it is an income test - Creamy layer is confined to the other backward classes
Qualified use: State an intra-category equity rule with both of its limbs before criticising it.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- The creamy layer as a status
- income filter
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Scheduled Castes
- Scheduled Tribes

How to use them: Frame the answer through The creamy layer as a status; define income filter, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Scheduled Castes for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

THE CREAMY LAYER AS A STATUS-AND-INCOME FILTER

01. The creamy layer is a status test before it is an income test

|
v

02. Creamy layer is confined to the other backward classes

BOUNDARY -> The filter is confined to the other backward classes and is not a simple gross-income limit.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground.
- The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The filter is confined to the other backward classes and is not a simple gross-income limit.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to The creamy layer as a status-and-income filter, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.
- **Mains:** State an intra-category equity rule with both of its limbs before criticising it.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** The creamy layer is a status test before it is an income test -> Creamy layer is confined to the other backward classes
- **Qualified use:** State an intra-category equity rule with both of its limbs before criticising it.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - THE CREAMY LAYER AS A STATUS-AND-INCOME FILTER

START / CONCEPT: CORE - The creamy layer as a status-and-income filter

|

v

EXACT TERMS: The creamy layer as a status · income filter · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Scheduled Castes · Scheduled Tribes

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The filter is confined to the other backward classes and is not a simple gross-income limit.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: The creamy layer is a status test before it is an income test - Creamy layer is confined to the other backward classes Qualified use: State an intra-category equity rule with both of its limbs before criticising it.

SESSION 6 - CORE - WHAT THE 1992 JUDGMENT SETTLED

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: What Indra Sawhney decided in 1992 Qualified use: Use a foundational judgment for the two features every later distribution argument turns on.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- What the 1992 judgment settled
- Evidence chain

- **Qualified use**
- **Indra Sawhney**
- **Union**
- **India**

How to use them: Frame the answer through What the 1992 judgment settled; define Evidence chain, connect Qualified use with Indra Sawhney to explain the mechanism, and use Union for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

WHAT THE 1992 JUDGMENT SETTLED

01. What Indra Sawhney decided in 1992

BOUNDARY -> Constitutional doctrine on the ceiling belongs to the Polity special-provisions owner and is cross-linked, not duplicated.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Constitutional doctrine on the ceiling belongs to the Polity special-provisions owner and is cross-linked, not duplicated.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to What the 1992 judgment settled, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.
- **Mains:** Use a foundational judgment for the two features every later distribution argument turns on.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** What Indra Sawhney decided in 1992
- **Qualified use:** Use a foundational judgment for the two features every later distribution argument turns on.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - WHAT THE 1992 JUDGMENT SETTLED

START / CONCEPT: CORE - What the 1992 judgment settled

|

v

EXACT TERMS: What the 1992 judgment settled · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Indra Sawhney · Union · India

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: What Indra Sawhney decided in 1992 Qualified use: Use a foundational judgment for the two features every later distribution argument turns on.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Constitutional doctrine on the ceiling belongs to the Polity special-provisions owner and is cross-linked, not duplicated.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: use a foundational judgment for the two features every later distribution argument turns on.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both.

SESSION 7 - CORE - THE ECONOMICALLY WEAKER SECTIONS CATEGORY AND ITS AMENDMENT

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: CORE - The economically weaker sections category and its amendment comprises The economically weaker sections category, its amendment and Evidence chain as its core connected dimensions.

Technical definition: The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: The economically weaker sections category and the 103rd Amendment Qualified use: Show that a design criticism is a criticism of the design and not evidence of administrative failure.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- The economically weaker sections category
- its amendment
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Article 15
- Article 16

How to use them: Frame the answer through The economically weaker sections category; define its amendment, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Article 15 for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

THE ECONOMICALLY WEAKER SECTIONS CATEGORY AND ITS AMENDMENT

01. The economically weaker sections category and the 103rd Amendment

BOUNDARY -> The category is defined by exclusion of the reserved categories as much as by economic weakness.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The category is defined by exclusion of the reserved categories as much as by economic weakness.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to The economically weaker sections category and its amendment, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.
- **Mains:** Show that a design criticism is a criticism of the design and not evidence of administrative failure.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** The economically weaker sections category and the 103rd Amendment
- **Qualified use:** Show that a design criticism is a criticism of the design and not evidence of administrative failure.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - THE ECONOMICALLY WEAKER SECTIONS CATEGORY AND ITS AMENDMENT

START / CONCEPT: CORE - The economically weaker sections category and its amendment

|
v

EXACT TERMS: The economically weaker sections category · its amendment · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Article 15 · Article 16

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Mains: Show that a design criticism is a criticism of the design and not evidence of administrative failure.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the category is defined by exclusion of the reserved categories as much as by...

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: The economically weaker sections category and the 103rd Amendment Qualified use: Show that a design criticism is a criticism of the design and not evidence of administrative failure.

SESSION 8 - CORE - THE NOTIFIED INCOME AND ASSET CRITERIA

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: The notified income and asset criteria for that category Qualified use: Quote a notified eligibility test completely rather than in its most quotable fragment.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- The notified income
- asset criteria
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Department

- Personnel

How to use them: Frame the answer through The notified income; define asset criteria, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Department for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

THE NOTIFIED INCOME AND ASSET CRITERIA

01. The notified income and asset criteria for that category

BOUNDARY -> The income limit is only one limb; the notified asset limits are the other.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The income limit is only one limb; the notified asset limits are the other.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to The notified income and asset criteria, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.
- **Mains:** Quote a notified eligibility test completely rather than in its most quotable fragment.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** The notified income and asset criteria for that category
- **Qualified use:** Quote a notified eligibility test completely rather than in its most quotable fragment.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - THE NOTIFIED INCOME AND ASSET CRITERIA

START / CONCEPT: CORE - The notified income and asset criteria

|

v

EXACT TERMS: The notified income · asset criteria · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Department · Personnel

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: The notified income and asset criteria for that category
Qualified use: Quote a notified eligibility test completely rather than in its most quotable fragment.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The income limit is only one limb; the notified asset limits are the other.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test.

SESSION 9 - CORE - THE 2022 JUDGMENT AND THE SHAPE OF THE DISAGREEMENT

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: Janhit Abhiyan in November 2022 and the shape of the disagreement
Qualified use: Present a contested constitutional holding with its majority reasoning and its dissent.

Technical definition: Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Janhit Abhiyan in November 2022 and the shape of the disagreement
Qualified use: Present a contested constitutional holding with its majority reasoning and its dissent.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- The 2022 judgment
- the shape of the disagreement
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Janhit Abhiyan
- Union

How to use them: Frame the answer through The 2022 judgment; define the shape of the disagreement, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Janhit Abhiyan for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

THE 2022 JUDGMENT AND THE SHAPE OF THE DISAGREEMENT

01. Janhit Abhiyan in November 2022 and the shape of the disagreement

BOUNDARY -> A three-to-two majority is a closely divided argument and not a settled consensus.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- A three-to-two majority is a closely divided argument and not a settled consensus.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to The 2022 judgment and the shape of the disagreement, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.
- **Mains:** Present a contested constitutional holding with its majority reasoning and its dissent.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Janhit Abhiyan in November 2022 and the shape of the disagreement
- **Qualified use:** Present a contested constitutional holding with its majority reasoning and its dissent.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - THE 2022 JUDGMENT AND THE SHAPE OF THE DISAGREEMENT

START / CONCEPT: CORE - The 2022 judgment and the shape of the disagreement

|

v

EXACT TERMS: The 2022 judgment · the shape of the disagreement · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Janhit Abhiyan · Union

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: A three-to-two majority is a closely divided argument and not a settled consensus.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: Janhit Abhiyan in November 2022 and the shape of the disagreement Qualified use.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Janhit Abhiyan in November 2022 and the shape of the disagreement Qualified use: Present a contested constitutional holding with its majority reasoning and its dissent.

SESSION 10 - CORE - TWO IDENTICAL FIGURES, TWO DIFFERENT TESTS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Evidence chain: Why two identical rupee figures are two different legal tests Qualified use: Defuse the sharpest close-option trap in this topic by naming the test being applied.

Technical definition: The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Why two identical rupee figures are two different legal tests Qualified use: Defuse the sharpest close-option trap in this topic by naming the test being applied.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Two identical figures
- two different tests
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Department
- Personnel

How to use them: Frame the answer through Two identical figures; define two different tests, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Department for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

TWO IDENTICAL FIGURES, TWO DIFFERENT TESTS

01. Why two identical rupee figures are two different legal tests

BOUNDARY -> Identical arithmetic proves nothing about identical eligibility.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- Identical arithmetic proves nothing about identical eligibility.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to Two identical figures, two different tests, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.
- **Mains:** Defuse the sharpest close-option trap in this topic by naming the test being applied.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Why two identical rupee figures are two different legal tests
- **Qualified use:** Defuse the sharpest close-option trap in this topic by naming the test being applied.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - TWO IDENTICAL FIGURES, TWO DIFFERENT TESTS

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Two identical figures, two different tests

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Two identical figures · two different tests · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Department · Personnel

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: Identical arithmetic proves nothing about identical eligibility.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic.

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Why two identical rupee figures are two different legal tests Qualified use: Defuse the sharpest close-option trap in this topic by naming the test being applied.

SESSION 11 - CORE - THE EDUCATION-SUPPORT FRAMEWORK AND ITS CATEGORY DISCIPLINE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: A scheme classification is not the constitutional category with a similar name.

Technical definition: The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- The education-support framework
- its category discipline
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use

- Ministry
- Social Justice

How to use them: Frame the answer through The education-support framework; define its category discipline, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Ministry for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

THE EDUCATION-SUPPORT FRAMEWORK AND ITS CATEGORY DISCIPLINE

01. The umbrella education-support framework for backward-class students

BOUNDARY -> A scheme classification is not the constitutional category with a similar name.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- A scheme classification is not the constitutional category with a similar name.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to The education-support framework and its category discipline, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.
- **Mains:** Attribute a benefit to the correct classification before using it as evidence of delivery.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** The umbrella education-support framework for backward-class students
- **Qualified use:** Attribute a benefit to the correct classification before using it as evidence of delivery.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - THE EDUCATION-SUPPORT FRAMEWORK AND ITS CATEGORY DISCIPLINE

START / CONCEPT: CORE - The education-support framework and its category discipline

|
v

EXACT TERMS: The education-support framework · its category discipline · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Ministry · Social Justice

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: The umbrella education-support framework for backward-class students Qualified use: Attribute a benefit to the correct classification before using it as evidence of delivery.

|
v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: A scheme classification is not the constitutional category with a similar name.

|
v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: the owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and...

|
v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment.

SESSION 12 - CORE - SUB-CATEGORISATION AND THE EXAMINING COMMISSION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Sub-categorisation and the commission that examined it Qualified use: Argue distribution from within-category concentration rather than from a general call for more funds.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- Sub-categorisation
- the examining commission
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Rohini Commission

- Qualified

How to use them: Frame the answer through Sub-categorisation; define the examining commission, connect Evidence chain with Qualified use to explain the mechanism, and use Rohini Commission for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

SUB-CATEGORISATION AND THE EXAMINING COMMISSION

01. Sub-categorisation and the commission that examined it

BOUNDARY -> The corrective measure depends on exactly the evidence the data gap withholds.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The corrective measure depends on exactly the evidence the data gap withholds.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to Sub-categorisation and the examining commission, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.
- **Mains:** Argue distribution from within-category concentration rather than from a general call for more funds.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Sub-categorisation and the commission that examined it
- **Qualified use:** Argue distribution from within-category concentration rather than from a general call for more funds.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE - SUB-CATEGORISATION AND THE EXAMINING COMMISSION

START / CONCEPT: CORE - Sub-categorisation and the examining commission

|

v

EXACT TERMS: Sub-categorisation · the examining commission · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Rohini Commission · Qualified

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Evidence chain: Sub-categorisation and the commission that examined it
Qualified use: Argue distribution from within-category concentration rather than from a general call for more funds.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The corrective measure depends on exactly the evidence the data gap withholds.

|

v

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: Do not miss this limiting distinction: sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other...

|

v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds.

SESSION 13 - CORE SYNTHESIS - THE CASTE-DATA GAP AND THE 2027 ENUMERATION STATUS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence.

Technical definition: An approved enumeration is a future evidence source and not present evidence.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: The caste-data gap and what the 2011 socio-economic survey did not settle - The 2027 enumeration decision and its exact status
Qualified use: Use a data gap to argue for measurement design without asserting any population share.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CORE SYNTHESIS
- The caste-data gap
- the 2027 enumeration status
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Socio Economic

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define The caste-data gap, connect the 2027 enumeration status with Evidence chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

THE CASTE-DATA GAP AND THE 2027 ENUMERATION STATUS

01. The caste-data gap and what the 2011 socio-economic survey did not settle

|
v

02. The 2027 enumeration decision and its exact status

BOUNDARY -> An approved enumeration is a future evidence source and not present evidence.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it.
- The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- An approved enumeration is a future evidence source and not present evidence.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to The caste-data gap and the 2027 enumeration status, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.
- **Mains:** Use a data gap to argue for measurement design without asserting any population share.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** The caste-data gap and what the 2011 socio-economic survey did not settle -> The 2027 enumeration decision and its exact status
- **Qualified use:** Use a data gap to argue for measurement design without asserting any population share.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - THE CASTE-DATA GAP AND THE 2027 ENUMERATION STATUS

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - The caste-data gap and the 2027 enumeration status

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EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · The caste-data gap · the 2027 enumeration status · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Socio Economic

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MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it.

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CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence.

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UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: An approved enumeration is a future evidence source and not present evidence.

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ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: The caste-data gap and what the 2011 socio-economic survey did not settle - The 2027 enumeration decision and its exact status Qualified use: Use a data gap to argue for measurement design without asserting any population share.

SESSION 14 - CORE SYNTHESIS - CERTIFICATE VERIFICATION AND THE IDENTIFICATION PARADOX

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support.

Technical definition: Evidence chain: Certificate verification as the administrative weak point of an income-based category - The identification paradox that constrains policy feedback Qualified use: Locate an administrative failure at the certificate stage rather than blaming the category.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Certificate verification as the administrative weak point of an income-based category - The identification paradox that constrains policy feedback Qualified use: Locate an administrative failure at the certificate stage rather than blaming the category.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CORE SYNTHESIS
- Certificate verification
- the identification paradox

- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Union Territory

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define Certificate verification, connect the identification paradox with Evidence chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

CERTIFICATE VERIFICATION AND THE IDENTIFICATION PARADOX

01. Certificate verification as the administrative weak point of an income-based category

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v

02. The identification paradox that constrains policy feedback

BOUNDARY -> The paradox is a statement about the missing evidence base and not a verdict on the outcome.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it.
- The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- The paradox is a statement about the missing evidence base and not a verdict on the outcome.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to Certificate verification and the identification paradox, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.
- **Mains:** Locate an administrative failure at the certificate stage rather than blaming the category.

MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Certificate verification as the administrative weak point of an income-based category -> The identification paradox that constrains policy feedback
- **Qualified use:** Locate an administrative failure at the certificate stage rather than blaming the category.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - CERTIFICATE VERIFICATION AND THE IDENTIFICATION PARADOX

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - Certificate verification and the identification paradox

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v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · Certificate verification · the identification paradox · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Union Territory

|
v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it.

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CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support.

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UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: The paradox is a statement about the missing evidence base and not a verdict on the outcome.

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v

ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Certificate verification as the administrative weak point of an income-based category - The identification paradox that constrains policy feedback
Qualified use: Locate an administrative failure at the certificate stage rather than blaming the category.

SESSION 15 - CORE SYNTHESIS - COVERAGE AGAINST MOBILITY AND THE HONEST OWNERSHIP STATEMENT

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Social mobility as outcome test: The ultimate goal is intergenerational uplift - children of beneficiaries achieving higher education and occupation than their parents - rather than static coverage numbers.

Technical definition: The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Evidence chain: Coverage, first-generation access and intergenerational mobility - The transparent ownership statement for this owner
Qualified use: Close with a coverage-against-mobility verdict and an explicit ownership and data boundary.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- CORE SYNTHESIS
- Coverage against mobility
- the honest ownership statement
- Evidence chain
- Qualified use
- Subject

How to use them: Frame the answer through CORE SYNTHESIS; define Coverage against mobility, connect the honest ownership statement with Evidence chain to explain the mechanism, and use Qualified use for the decisive comparison or qualification.

VISUAL FIRST

COVERAGE AGAINST MOBILITY AND THE HONEST OWNERSHIP STATEMENT

01. Coverage, first-generation access and intergenerational mobility

|
v

02. The transparent ownership statement for this owner

BOUNDARY -> No Mains or objective demand is routed to this owner, and none is manufactured.

This topic-specific rail fixes the evidence sequence and its exam boundary before analysis.

CORE EXPLANATION

The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation.

NAMED EVIDENCE AND MECHANISM

- The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome.
- The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model

solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation.

EXAMINER CAUTION

- No Mains or objective demand is routed to this owner, and none is manufactured.

EXAM LINK

- **Prelims:** Retain the exact statute, section, article, ministry, official category, survey round or dated edition attached to Coverage against mobility and the honest ownership statement, and never upgrade a policy document into a statute or a targeted scheme into a universal entitlement.
- **Mains:** Close with a coverage-against-mobility verdict and an explicit ownership and data boundary.

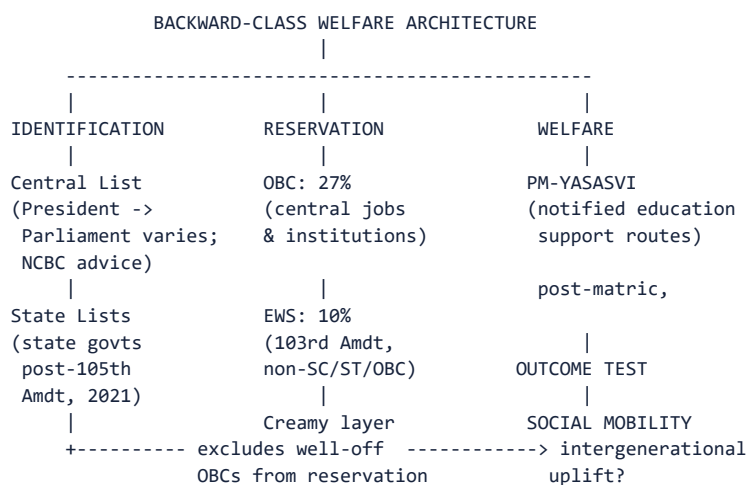
MINI RECAP

- **Evidence chain:** Coverage, first-generation access and intergenerational mobility -> The transparent ownership statement for this owner
- **Qualified use:** Close with a coverage-against-mobility verdict and an explicit ownership and data boundary.

COMPLETE BASIC OWNER EVIDENCE BANK

Subject: Social Justice | **Tier:** Must-Do (foundation) | **GS Paper:** GS-II; cross-cuts GS-I (society, mobility) and GS-III (inclusive growth). **Core area:** Other Backward Classes, Economically Weaker Sections, creamy layer, social mobility, Central/State OBC lists, PM-YASASVI. **Grounded in:** National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993; 102nd and 105th Constitutional Amendment Acts; 103rd Constitutional Amendment Act, 2019 (EWS); Indra Sawhney v. Union of India (1992); Janhit Abhiyan v. Union of India (2022); PM-YASASVI scheme guidelines; Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment. **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = analytical inference | **CURRENT:** = current anchor. *Companion:* advanced/09_OBC-EWS-and-Social-Mobility.md.

1. Visual foundation



Core proposition: FACT: OBC reservation addresses historical social and educational backwardness; EWS reservation addresses economic disadvantage among non-reserved categories. Together, they aim for substantive equality, but their impact must be measured through intergenerational social mobility - not merely scheme coverage.

2. Essential definitions

Concept	Exam-ready meaning
FACT: Other Backward Classes (OBC)	Socially and educationally backward classes of citizens other than Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes, identified on the basis of social and educational backwardness (not solely economic) and entitled to reservation under Articles 15(4) and 16(4).
FACT: Central OBC List	The list of socially and educationally backward classes for central purposes under Article 342A. The President specifies the Central List and Parliament alone may include or exclude a community; NCBC consultation/advice is part of the institutional process, not a power to add a community by itself.
FACT: State OBC Lists	Lists maintained by state governments for state-level reservations; after the 105th Constitutional Amendment Act, 2021, states regained explicit power to prepare their own OBC/SEBC lists for state purposes.
FACT: Creamy layer	An OBC exclusion rule based primarily on the parents' service/status categories and, where the income/wealth test applies, the notified Rs 8 lakh ceiling for three consecutive years. Salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; do not reduce the rule to "family income above Rs 8 lakh".
FACT: Economically Weaker Sections (EWS)	A category introduced by the 103rd Constitutional Amendment Act, 2019, enabling up to 10% reservation in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall under SC/ST/OBC categories, based on a gross annual family income below Rs 8 lakh and specified asset limits (notified January 2019).
ANALYSIS: Social mobility	Intergenerational movement in educational attainment, occupational status or income; the ultimate test of whether backward-class welfare converts into durable uplift, not merely first-generation access.

3. How OBC/EWS reservation and welfare work (mechanism)

- OBC identification:** For the Central List, the constitutional Article 342A route applies (President specifies; Parliament varies); NCBC has consultative/advisory and safeguards functions. State governments maintain their own lists for State purposes after the 105th Amendment.
- Creamy-layer filter:** Before claiming OBC reservation, an applicant must obtain a certificate verifying they do not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion criteria (income ceiling and parental office threshold, periodically revised).
- Reservation implementation:** 27% reservation for OBCs in central services and central educational institutions; 10% EWS reservation (post-2019) for non-SC/ST/OBC economically weaker citizens - see Polity for constitutional-doctrine detail.
- Welfare schemes:** PM-YASASVI bundles support for OBC, EBC and DNT students, including pre-/post-matric and top-class education routes and other notified components. Check the applicable annual guideline rather than assuming every component is open in every State or year.
- Social mobility as outcome test:** The ultimate goal is intergenerational uplift - children of beneficiaries achieving higher education and occupation than their parents - rather than static coverage numbers.

4. Institutions and tools

- FACT: **National Commission for Backward Classes (NCBC):** A constitutional body (post-

102nd Amendment, 2018) with mandate to examine inclusion/exclusion requests and recommend changes to the Central OBC List; advises on policy and grievances. For detailed composition and constitutional mandate, see [Polity/basic/National-Commissions-SC-ST-BC.md](#).

- **FACT: 105th Constitutional Amendment Act, 2021:** Restored states' power to prepare their own OBC/SEBC lists for state-level reservation after the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case (2021) held that only Parliament could do so under the 102nd Amendment's wording; this Act clarified the President's list binds only central purposes, freeing states for state purposes.

- **FACT: 103rd Constitutional Amendment Act, 2019:** Inserted Articles 15(6) and 16(6) enabling up to 10% EWS reservation; upheld by the Supreme Court in *Janhit Abhiyan v. Union of India* (November 2022) by a 3-2 majority. For constitutional-validity reasoning, see [Polity/basic/Special-Provisions.md](#).

- **FACT: PM-YASASVI (Young Achievers' Scholarship Award Scheme for Vibrant India):** umbrella support for OBC, EBC and DNT students under the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment. Its scholarship/coaching components and State implementation should be identified from the current guideline; EBC is not interchangeable with the constitutional EWS category.

- **ANALYSIS: EWS certificate:** Issued by state/UT authorities certifying that the applicant's family meets the income and asset criteria for EWS reservation - an administrative verification challenge given income-based (vs caste-based) identification.

5. Indian applications and examples

- **ANALYSIS:** A first-generation college graduate from an OBC family who becomes a professional and whose child enters a top-tier institution illustrates successful intergenerational social mobility - the intended outcome, not merely reservation-slot uptake.

- **ANALYSIS:** The creamy-layer exclusion prevents the benefits of OBC reservation from being captured repeatedly by the already-advanced section within the OBC category.

- **ANALYSIS:** EWS reservation faced the challenge of income-based identification - verifying annual income is administratively harder than verifying caste-based certificates, raising exclusion and fraud risks.

6. Must-Know Facts for Prelims

- **FACT:** NCBC is a constitutional body (post-102nd Amendment, 2018); earlier it was a statutory body under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993.

- **FACT:** 27% OBC reservation in central services/institutions; 10% EWS reservation (post-103rd Amendment, 2019) for non-SC/ST/OBC economically weaker citizens.

- **FACT:** Creamy-layer exclusion applies to OBC reservation; it does NOT apply to SC/ST reservation.

- **FACT:** The OBC creamy-layer income/wealth ceiling is Rs 8 lakh (last revised September 2017), but its parental service/status categories and exclusions for salary/agricultural income matter. The EWS criterion also uses Rs 8 lakh plus asset limits, but the two tests are legally different.

- **FACT:** The 105th Constitutional Amendment Act, 2021 restored states' power to prepare their own OBC lists for state-level reservation.

- **FACT:** PM-YASASVI covers OBC, EBC and DNT students with pre-matric, post-matric and top-class education scholarships.

7. UPSC traps

- **WRONG:** Creamy layer applies to SC/ST reservation. -> **FACT:** Creamy layer applies ONLY to OBC reservation; SC/ST reservation has no creamy-layer exclusion as per the *Indra Sawhney* judgment and subsequent jurisprudence.

- **WRONG:** The NCBC can directly add communities to the Central OBC List. -> **FACT:** NCBC only

recommends; Parliament must act on the recommendation to include/exclude communities from the Central List.

- **WRONG:** EWS reservation is for economically weaker OBCs. -> **FACT:** EWS reservation under the 103rd Amendment is for economically weaker citizens who are NOT SC/ST/OBC; OBCs have their separate 27% reservation.

- **WRONG:** States cannot prepare their own OBC lists after the 102nd Amendment. -> **FACT:** The 105th Amendment (2021) explicitly restored states' power to prepare their own OBC lists for state-level reservation purposes.

8. CURRENT: Current anchor

- **CURRENT: Census 2027 status (21 July 2026):** the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included. Census 2027 is planned as an all-digital exercise; the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April-30 September 2026. This is an approved, ongoing operation - not published caste data, a completed methodology or an automatic basis for revising OBC lists.

- **FACT:** The OBC income/wealth ceiling is Rs 8 lakh (DoPT, September 2017), but quote the full creamy-layer test - parental status/service categories and income exclusions - rather than calling it a simple gross-family-income limit.

9. PYQ application

- **ANALYSIS:** There is no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 GS-II Mains PYQ specifically on OBC/EWS in the audited local PYQ texts. However, the topic intersects with broader social- justice and reservation questions. A strong Mains answer should distinguish OBC (social-educational backwardness) from EWS (economic backwardness), explain the creamy-layer rationale, cite the 2022 Janhit Abhiyan judgment for EWS, and link reservation to social-mobility outcomes.

10. Mains angles

- **ANALYSIS:** Frame OBC reservation as addressing caste-based social and educational backwardness, and EWS reservation as addressing economic disadvantage among non-reserved categories.

- **ANALYSIS:** Use the creamy-layer mechanism to explain intra-group equity within OBC reservation.

- **ANALYSIS:** Distinguish coverage (reservation slots filled, scholarships disbursed) from outcome (intergenerational mobility, educational/occupational progression).

- **ANALYSIS:** The caste-data gap remains a policy lacuna: the 2027 enumeration decision is approved and operations have begun, but results, validation and any policy use are still unavailable.

Answer thesis: OBC reservation addresses historical social-educational backwardness with a creamy-layer filter to ensure intra-group equity, while EWS reservation addresses pure economic disadvantage among non-reserved categories; their success must be judged not by coverage statistics alone but by intergenerational social mobility. Census 2027 may later improve the evidence base, but a decision to enumerate caste is not yet usable population evidence.

11. Probable questions

- **ANALYSIS: Prelims:** Which constitutional amendment restored states' power to prepare their own OBC lists for state-level reservation purposes?

- **ANALYSIS: Mains (10 marks):** Distinguish OBC reservation from EWS reservation with reference to the constitutional basis, identification criteria and judicial pronouncements.

- **ANALYSIS: Mains (15 marks):** "Reservation is a means to social mobility, not an end in itself." Critically examine this statement in the context of backward-class welfare policy in India.

11A. Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

- **Doctrine:** *Indra Sawhney* on OBC reservation, creamy layer and ordinary 50% ceiling; 102nd/105th Amendments on NCBC and State lists; *Janhit Abhiyan* upheld EWS reservation.

- **Sub-classification:** Rohini Commission examined unequal OBC benefit distribution;

internal classification needs credible data and safeguards against capture.

- **Mobility chain:** identification -> capabilities -> entry -> retention/promotion ->

assets and social acceptance.

10 marks: distinguish OBC and EWS criteria. **15 marks:** doctrine, data, creamy layer, sub-classification and design.

20 marks: compensatory discrimination, poverty relief, representation, federalism and intra-group inequality.

Reasoned verdict: Affirmative action needs fair internal distribution and complementary capability investment to create durable mobility.

12. Study links

- FACT: Advanced companion: advanced/09_OBC-EWS-and-Social-Mobility.md.

- FACT: Polity/basic/Special-Provisions.md - constitutional reservation doctrine, 103rd Amendment EWS validity (Janhit Abhiyan), and 50% ceiling jurisprudence.

- FACT: Polity/basic/National-Commissions-SC-ST-BC.md - NCBC constitutional status, composition and mandate.

- FACT: basic/07_Scheduled-Castes-Rights-Atrocities-and-Welfare.md - SC reservation and welfare architecture, for comparison with OBC/EWS targeting.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - CORE SYNTHESIS - COVERAGE AGAINST MOBILITY AND THE HONEST OWNERSHIP STATEMENT

START / CONCEPT: CORE SYNTHESIS - Coverage against mobility and the honest ownership statement

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v

EXACT TERMS: CORE SYNTHESIS · Coverage against mobility · the honest ownership statement · Evidence chain · Qualified use · Subject

|

v

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT: Together, they aim for substantive equality, but their impact must be measured through intergenerational social mobility - not merely scheme coverage.

|

v

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST: The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome.

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UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE: ANALYSIS: Frame OBC reservation as addressing caste-based social and educational backwardness, and EWS reservation as addressing economic disadvantage among non-reserved categories. ANALYSIS: Use the creamy-layer mechanism to explain intra-group equity within OBC reservation. ANALYSIS: Distinguish coverage (reservation slots filled, scholarships disbursed) from outcome (intergenerational mobility, educational/occupational progression). ANALYSIS: The caste-data gap remains a policy lacuna: the 2027 enumeration decision is approved and operations have begun, but results, validation and any policy use are still unavailable.

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ANSWER-GRABBING FORMULATION: Evidence chain: Coverage, first-generation access and intergenerational mobility - The transparent ownership statement for this owner Qualified use: Close with a coverage-against-mobility verdict and an explicit ownership and data boundary.

SOCIAL JUSTICE DEEP-REVIEW CORE CONTROL

- **Must remember:** OBC, EWS and social mobility analysis separates social and educational backwardness, economic disadvantage, representation, capability, discrimination and intergenerational mobility across different constitutional and policy routes.
- **Close distinction:** OBC is not a synonym for poverty, EWS is not an OBC sub-category, creamy-layer doctrine does not travel identically across every reservation category, a commission recommendation is not automatic inclusion, and mobility is not proof that structural barriers disappeared.
- **Authority / evidence / implementation limit:** Use Articles 15, 16 and 342A, NCBC, list competence and judicial ceilings/qualifications precisely; map identification, data, notification, eligibility, certificate, grievance, representation and outcomes while avoiding unqualified quota or fiscal claims.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Q1. Which statement correctly identifies What this owner holds and why its previous-year record is stated as zero?

A. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. B. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. C. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. D. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed.

Answer: A. Explanation: This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II

question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q2. Which chronology card should be filed under What this owner holds and why its previous-year record is stated as zero?

A. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted. B. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. C. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. D. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation.

Answer: B. Explanation: This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q3. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of What this owner holds and why its previous-year record is stated as zero?

A. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted. B. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. C. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. D. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed.

Answer: C. Explanation: This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q4. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about What this owner holds and why its previous-year record is stated as zero?

A. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. B. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted. C. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. D. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here.

Answer: D. Explanation: This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q5. Which statement correctly identifies The constitutional and statutory bank for a backward-class answer?

A. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story.

B. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation.

C. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted.

D. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q6. Which chronology card should be filed under The constitutional and statutory bank for a backward-class answer?

A. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading

had removed. B. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. C. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. D. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q7. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The constitutional and statutory bank for a backward-class answer?

A. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. B. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is

asserted. C. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. D. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q8. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The constitutional and statutory bank for a backward-class answer?

A. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. B. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in *Indra Sawhney* against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. C. *Indra Sawhney* against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both. D. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the

backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q9. Which statement correctly identifies The Central List route under Article 342A?

A. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. B. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted. C. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. D. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground.

Answer: A. Explanation: For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q10. Which chronology card should be filed under The Central List route under Article 342A?

A. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. B. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. C. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. D. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted.

Answer: B. Explanation: For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q11. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The Central List route under Article 342A?

A. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. B. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. C. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the

socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. D. *Indra Sawhney against Union of India*, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both.

Answer: C. Explanation: For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q12. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The Central List route under Article 342A?

A. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in *Indra Sawhney against Union of India* and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. B. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. C. *Indra Sawhney against Union of India*, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both. D. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation.

Answer: D. Explanation: For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution

inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q13. Which statement correctly identifies State lists and the restoration effected by the 105th Amendment?

A. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. B. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. C. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted. D. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground.

Answer: A. Explanation: State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q14. Which chronology card should be filed under State lists and the restoration effected by the 105th Amendment?

A. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. B. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. C. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. D. Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both.

Answer: B. Explanation: State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q15. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of State lists and the restoration effected by the 105th Amendment?

A. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. B. Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both. C. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the

present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. D. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure.

Answer: C. Explanation: State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q16. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about State lists and the restoration effected by the 105th Amendment?

A. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. B. Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both. C. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. D. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed.

Answer: D. Explanation: State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q17. Which statement correctly identifies The commission's own account of its constitutional status?

A. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted. B. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. C. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. D. Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both.

Answer: A. Explanation: The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q18. Which chronology card should be filed under The commission's own account of its constitutional status?

A. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. B. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted. C. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. D. Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both.

Answer: B. Explanation: The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q19. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The commission's own account of its constitutional status?

A. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 1919, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. B. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019

inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. C. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted. D. Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both.

Answer: C. Explanation: The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q20. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The commission's own account of its constitutional status?

A. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. B. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. C. Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure

when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus. D. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted.

Answer: D. Explanation: The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q21. Which statement correctly identifies The creamy layer is a status test before it is an income test?

A. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. B. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. C. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. D. Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a

quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q22. Which chronology card should be filed under The creamy layer is a status test before it is an income test?

A. Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both. B. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. C. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. D. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q23. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The creamy layer is a status test before it is an income test?

A. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. B. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. C. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. D. Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q24. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The creamy layer is a status test before it is an income test?

A. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. B. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed

test. C. Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus. D. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q25. Which statement correctly identifies Creamy layer is confined to the other backward classes?

A. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. B. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. C. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. D. Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an

other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q26. Which chronology card should be filed under Creamy layer is confined to the other backward classes?

A. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. B. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. C. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. D. Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q27. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Creamy layer is confined to the other backward classes?

A. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. B. Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not

violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus. C. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in *Indra Sawhney* against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. D. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in *Indra Sawhney* against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q28. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Creamy layer is confined to the other backward classes?

A. *Janhit Abhiyan* against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus. B. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. C. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. D. The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in *Indra Sawhney* against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to

assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in *Indra Sawhney* against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q29. Which statement correctly identifies What *Indra Sawhney* decided in 1992?

A. *Indra Sawhney* against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both. B. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. C. *Janhit Abhiyan* against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus. D. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test.

Answer: A. Explanation: *Indra Sawhney* against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q30. Which chronology card should be filed under What Indra Sawhney decided in 1992?

A. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. B. Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both. C. Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus. D. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying.

Answer: B. Explanation: Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q31. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of What Indra Sawhney decided in 1992?

A. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. B. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. C. Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services

and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both. D. Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus.

Answer: C. Explanation: Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q32. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about What Indra Sawhney decided in 1992?

A. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. B. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. C. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. D. Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both.

Answer: D. Explanation: Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it

fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q33. Which statement correctly identifies The economically weaker sections category and the 103rd Amendment?

A. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. B. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. C. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. D. Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus.

Answer: A. Explanation: The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q34. Which chronology card should be filed under The economically weaker sections category and the 103rd Amendment?

A. Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus. B. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public

employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. C. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. D. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying.

Answer: B. Explanation: The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q35. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The economically weaker sections category and the 103rd Amendment?

A. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. B. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. C. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. D. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and

post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment.

Answer: C. Explanation: The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q36. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The economically weaker sections category and the 103rd Amendment?

A. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. B. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. C. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. D. The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure.

Answer: D. Explanation: The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q37. Which statement correctly identifies The notified income and asset criteria for that category?

A. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. B. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. C. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. D. Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q38. Which chronology card should be filed under The notified income and asset criteria for that category?

A. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. B. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed

test. C. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. D. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q39. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The notified income and asset criteria for that category?

A. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. B. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. C. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. D. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft

or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q40. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The notified income and asset criteria for that category?

A. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. B. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. C. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. D. The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q41. Which statement correctly identifies Janhit Abhiyan in November 2022 and the shape of the disagreement?

A. Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus. B. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to

examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. C. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. D. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment.

Answer: A. Explanation: Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q42. Which chronology card should be filed under Janhit Abhiyan in November 2022 and the shape of the disagreement?

A. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. B. Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus. C. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. D. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category

are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it.

Answer: B. Explanation: Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q43. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Janhit Abhiyan in November 2022 and the shape of the disagreement?

A. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. B. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. C. Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus. D. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it.

Answer: C. Explanation: Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q44. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Janhit Abhiyan in November 2022 and the shape of the disagreement?

A. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. B. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. C. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. D. Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus.

Answer: D. Explanation: Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q45. Which statement correctly identifies Why two identical rupee figures are two different legal tests?

A. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. B. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. C. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that

the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. D. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q46. Which chronology card should be filed under Why two identical rupee figures are two different legal tests?

A. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. B. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. C. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. D. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically

weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q47. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Why two identical rupee figures are two different legal tests?

A. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. B. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. C. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. D. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q48. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Why two identical rupee figures are two different legal tests?

A. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. B. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges:

coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. C. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. D. The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q49. Which statement correctly identifies The umbrella education-support framework for backward-class students?

A. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. B. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. C. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. D. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions

match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q50. Which chronology card should be filed under The umbrella education-support framework for backward-class students?

A. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. B. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. C. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. D. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q51. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The umbrella education-support framework for backward-class students?

A. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. B. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. C. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. D. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q52. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The umbrella education-support framework for backward-class students?

A. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. B. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document

income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. C. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. D. The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q53. Which statement correctly identifies Sub-categorisation and the commission that examined it?

A. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. B. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. C. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. D. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it.

Answer: A. Explanation: Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q54. Which chronology card should be filed under Sub-categorisation and the commission that examined it?

A. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. B. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. C. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. D. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it.

Answer: B. Explanation: Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q55. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Sub-categorisation and the commission that examined it?

A. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. B. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. C. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. D. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome.

Answer: C. Explanation: Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q56. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Sub-categorisation and the commission that examined it?

A. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. B. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D

rotation. C. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. D. Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds.

Answer: D. Explanation: Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q57. Which statement correctly identifies The caste-data gap and what the 2011 socio-economic survey did not settle?

A. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. B. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. C. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. D. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which

sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q58. Which chronology card should be filed under The caste-data gap and what the 2011 socio-economic survey did not settle?

A. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. B. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. C. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. D. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q59. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The caste-data gap and what the 2011 socio-economic survey did not settle?

A. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. B. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025

General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. C. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. D. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q60. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The caste-data gap and what the 2011 socio-economic survey did not settle?

A. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. B. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. C. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim

about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. D. The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q61. Which statement correctly identifies The 2027 enumeration decision and its exact status?

A. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. B. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. C. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. D. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q62. Which chronology card should be filed under The 2027 enumeration decision and its exact status?

A. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. B. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. C. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. D. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q63. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The 2027 enumeration decision and its exact status?

A. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. B. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions,

evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. C. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. D. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q64. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The 2027 enumeration decision and its exact status?

A. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. B. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. C. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent

for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. D. The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q65. Which statement correctly identifies Certificate verification as the administrative weak point of an income-based category?

A. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. B. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. C. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. D. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or

Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q66. Which chronology card should be filed under Certificate verification as the administrative weak point of an income-based category?

A. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. B. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. C. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. D. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q67. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Certificate verification as the administrative weak point of an income-based category?

A. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. B. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. C. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. D. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q68. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Certificate verification as the administrative weak point of an income-based category?

A. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. B. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. C. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. D. The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q69. Which statement correctly identifies Coverage, first-generation access and intergenerational mobility?

A. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. B. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of

beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. C. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. D. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q70. Which chronology card should be filed under Coverage, first-generation access and intergenerational mobility?

A. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. B. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. C. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second

Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. D. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q71. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of Coverage, first-generation access and intergenerational mobility?

A. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. B. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. C. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. D. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of

backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q72. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about Coverage, first-generation access and intergenerational mobility?

A. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. B. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. C. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. D. The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q73. Which statement correctly identifies The identification paradox that constrains policy feedback?

A. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. B. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. C. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. D. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here.

Answer: A. Explanation: The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q74. Which chronology card should be filed under The identification paradox that constrains policy feedback?

A. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in

minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here. B. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. C. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. D. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story.

Answer: B. Explanation: The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q75. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The identification paradox that constrains policy feedback?

A. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. B. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. C. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather

than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. D. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story.

Answer: C. Explanation: The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q76. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The identification paradox that constrains policy feedback?

A. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted. B. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. C. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. D. The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support.

Answer: D. Explanation: The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary

proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q77. Which statement correctly identifies The transparent ownership statement for this owner?

A. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. B. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. C. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. D. This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here.

Answer: A. Explanation: The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q78. Which chronology card should be filed under The transparent ownership statement for this owner?

A. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. B. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. C. The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. D. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation.

Answer: B. Explanation: The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q79. Which option preserves the source-bounded meaning of The transparent ownership statement for this owner?

A. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted. B. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. C. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. D. For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation.

Answer: C. Explanation: The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

Q80. Which statement avoids a close-option trap about The transparent ownership statement for this owner?

A. The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. B. The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted. C. State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. D. The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation.

Answer: D. Explanation: The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. The remaining options belong to different chronology, actor or analytical categories.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

TRANSPARENT ZERO-DIRECT-PYQ AUDIT

The audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner for the covered years, and that zero is reported openly rather than concealed or filled with a manufactured demand card. The four audited ledgers consulted are the Mains routing ledgers for 2018 to 2023 and for 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims routing ledgers for 2018 to 2023 and for 2024 to 2025, and neither the Basic owner nor the Advanced owner for this topic carries a generated previous-year integration block, which is itself consistent with that zero. Both owners state independently that there is no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question specifically on the other backward classes or the economically weaker sections in the audited local previous-year texts, and this package adopts exactly that position. The two nearest neighbouring demands are the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from a statutory to a constitutional body, and the audited 2018-2023 Mains routing ledger routes both to the Polity commissions owner together with the consolidated body-design owner, so no ownership is claimed over either here; reservation doctrine such as the ordinary fifty per cent ceiling and the constitutional validity reasoning for the economic criterion is likewise routed to the Polity special-provisions owner and is cross-linked rather than duplicated. The practice in this package therefore consists of six original Mains questions with model solutions, each written to the repository's examiner-grade standard using the claim, named evidence, analysis and qualification pattern, together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation. Each model solution opens with its analytical claim so that the evidence which follows does argumentative rather than decorative work. The locally held OCR-searchable official General Studies papers were read only to confirm that no question on this owner's subject matter is routed here; no question was invented from them, no marking scheme or page precision was imported and no official answer key is claimed for any question anywhere in this package.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on "TRANSPARENT ZERO-DIRECT-PYQ AUDIT", every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The answer must resolve the Social Justice demand in "TRANSPARENT ZERO-DIRECT-PYQ AUDIT".

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** Define the vulnerable group, deprivation, right or policy concept and distinguish the nearest legal and measured category. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.
Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** Identify the constitutional, statutory, judicial or executive basis and the competent Union, state or local institution. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.
Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** Map rights-holder, household/community context, duty-bearer, frontline worker, provider and accountability forum. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.
Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** Trace identification, eligibility, documentation, finance, access, portability, grievance, appeal and correction. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.
Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal

limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

5. **Claim and named evidence:** Use a named Indian law, judgment, scheme, institution or official dataset with source, date, denominator and status. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.

Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

6. **Claim and named evidence:** Test intersectionality, regional variation, stigma, accessibility, privacy, fiscal adequacy, exclusion and causal limits. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction.

Qualification: State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The answer must resolve the Social Justice demand in "TRANSPARENT ZERO-DIRECT-PYQ AUDIT".

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For "TRANSPARENT ZERO-DIRECT-PYQ AUDIT", replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

OWNER PYQ LEDGER EXTRACTS

9. PYQ application

- ANALYSIS: There is no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 GS-II Mains PYQ specifically on OBC/EWS in the audited local PYQ texts. However, the topic intersects with broader social-justice and reservation questions. A strong Mains answer should distinguish OBC (social-educational backwardness) from EWS (economic backwardness), explain the creamy-layer rationale, cite the 2022 Janhit Abhiyan judgment for EWS, and link reservation to social-mobility outcomes.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: There is no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 GS-II Mains PYQ specifically on OBC/EWS in the audited local PYQ texts. A strong Mains answer should: (a) distinguish social-educational backwardness (OBC) from economic backwardness (EWS), (b) explain the creamy-layer rationale and its limitations, (c) cite Janhit Abhiyan (2022) for EWS constitutional validity, (d) note the caste-data gap and the 2027 Census decision, and (e) frame reservation as a means to social mobility, not an end in itself.

ORIGINAL MAINS 1 - 10 MARKS

Question: Distinguish reservation for the other backward classes from reservation for the economically weaker sections with reference to their constitutional basis and identification criteria. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The two routes rest on different enabling provisions and different tests, so the distinction must name Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) against Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), then show that social and educational backwardness and a notified income-and-asset test are not interchangeable evidence.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story.
- The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure.
- The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test.
- The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying.

Qualified conclusion: The two routes rest on different enabling provisions and different tests, so the distinction must name Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) against Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), then show that social and educational backwardness and a notified income-and-asset test are not interchangeable evidence.

Demand decoding: The directive **answer** requires a direct position on “Distinguish reservation for the other backward classes from reservation for the economically...”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The two routes rest on different enabling provisions and different tests, so the distinction must name Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) against Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), then show that social and educational backwardness and a notified income-and-asset test are not interchangeable evidence.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
4. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The two routes rest on different enabling provisions and different tests, so the distinction must name Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) against Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), then show that social and educational backwardness and a notified income-and-asset test are not interchangeable evidence.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Distinguish reservation for the other backward classes from reservation for the economically...”, replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 2 - 10 MARKS

Question: Explain the rationale of the creamy-layer exclusion within backward-class reservation and examine its limitations. Answer in about 150 words.

Model thesis: The exclusion exists to stop repeated capture by the already advanced inside a listed category, so the explanation must state its status limb before its income limb and then locate its limits in threshold lag and in the absence of any comparable filter elsewhere.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground.
- The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category.
- Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both.
- The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome.

Qualified conclusion: The exclusion exists to stop repeated capture by the already advanced inside a listed category, so the explanation must state its status limb before its income limb and then locate its limits in threshold lag and in the absence of any comparable filter elsewhere.

Demand decoding: The directive **explain** requires a direct position on “Explain the rationale of the creamy-layer exclusion within backward-class reservation and...”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction,

rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The exclusion exists to stop repeated capture by the already advanced inside a listed category, so the explanation must state its status limb before its income limb and then locate its limits in threshold lag and in the absence of any comparable filter elsewhere.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** Indra Sawhney against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity,

remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The exclusion exists to stop repeated capture by the already advanced inside a listed category, so the explanation must state its status limb before its income limb and then locate its limits in threshold lag and in the absence of any comparable filter elsewhere.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 10 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Explain the rationale of the creamy-layer exclusion within backward-class reservation and...”, replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 3 - 15 MARKS

Question: Critically examine the claim that the absence of published caste data undermines evidence-based backward-class policy. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: The gap bites on calibration rather than on entitlement, so the examination must separate what cannot be computed without a dataset from what remains constitutionally secure with one, and must treat the forthcoming enumeration as a future source and not as present evidence.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it.
- The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence.
- The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support.
- Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds.

Qualified conclusion: The gap bites on calibration rather than on entitlement, so the examination must separate what cannot be computed without a dataset from what remains constitutionally secure with one, and must treat the forthcoming enumeration as a future source and not as present evidence.

Demand decoding: The directive **critically examine** requires a direct position on “Critically examine the claim that the absence of published caste data undermines evidence-...”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: The gap bites on calibration rather than on entitlement, so the examination must separate what cannot be computed without a dataset from what remains constitutionally secure with one, and must treat the forthcoming enumeration as a future source and not as present evidence.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility,

dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: The gap bites on calibration rather than on entitlement, so the examination must separate what cannot be computed without a dataset from what remains constitutionally secure with one, and must treat the forthcoming enumeration as a future source and not as present evidence.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Critically examine the claim that the absence of published caste data undermines evidence-...”, replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 4 - 15 MARKS

Question: Assess the constitutional reasoning by which reservation on a purely economic criterion was upheld in 2022 and the objections it left open. Answer in about 250 words.

Model thesis: A three-to-two majority is an argument and not a consensus, so the assessment must state the majority reasoning on a new category and the ceiling, state the dissent on substantive equality, and tie both to the exact notified test that was before the Court.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure.
- Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus.
- The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test.
- The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also

stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying.

Qualified conclusion: A three-to-two majority is an argument and not a consensus, so the assessment must state the majority reasoning on a new category and the ceiling, state the dissent on substantive equality, and tie both to the exact notified test that was before the Court.

Demand decoding: The directive **assess** requires a direct position on “Assess the constitutional reasoning by which reservation on a purely economic criterion was...”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: A three-to-two majority is an argument and not a consensus, so the assessment must state the majority reasoning on a new category and the ceiling, state the dissent on substantive equality, and tie both to the exact notified test that was before the Court.

Analytical body:

- 1. Claim and named evidence:** The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 2. Claim and named evidence:** Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 3. Claim and named evidence:** The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
- 4. Claim and named evidence:** The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done

so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: A three-to-two majority is an argument and not a consensus, so the assessment must state the majority reasoning on a new category and the ceiling, state the dissent on substantive equality, and tie both to the exact notified test that was before the Court.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 15 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Assess the constitutional reasoning by which reservation on a purely economic criterion was...”, replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 5 - 20 MARKS

Question: Analyse why reservation and scholarship coverage is an inadequate measure of social mobility, and what a better measurement architecture would require. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Coverage counts an administrative event while mobility is a cohort outcome, so the analysis must separate coverage, first-generation access and intergenerational progression, then specify the data, the unit and the time horizon that a mobility measure actually needs.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome.
- The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment.

- The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support.
- The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it.

Qualified conclusion: Coverage counts an administrative event while mobility is a cohort outcome, so the analysis must separate coverage, first-generation access and intergenerational progression, then specify the data, the unit and the time horizon that a mobility measure actually needs.

Demand decoding: The directive **analyse** requires a direct position on “Analyse why reservation and scholarship coverage is an inadequate measure of social mobility,...”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Coverage counts an administrative event while mobility is a cohort outcome, so the analysis must separate coverage, first-generation access and intergenerational progression, then specify the data, the unit and the time horizon that a mobility measure actually needs.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome.
Analysis: Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
3. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions,

evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Coverage counts an administrative event while mobility is a cohort outcome, so the analysis must separate coverage, first-generation access and intergenerational progression, then specify the data, the unit and the time horizon that a mobility measure actually needs.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Analyse why reservation and scholarship coverage is an inadequate measure of social mobility,...”, replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

ORIGINAL MAINS 6 - 20 MARKS

Question: Evaluate the proposition that backward-class policy in India has solved identification but not distribution. Answer in about 300 words.

Model thesis: Identification and distribution are different problems with different instruments, so the evaluation must show that the list-making route is settled while the division of the quota inside the category is not, and must close with a graded verdict that is honest about the missing evidence.

Claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification:

- For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation.

- State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed.
- Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds.
- The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome.

Qualified conclusion: Identification and distribution are different problems with different instruments, so the evaluation must show that the list-making route is settled while the division of the quota inside the category is not, and must close with a graded verdict that is honest about the missing evidence.

Demand decoding: The directive **evaluate** requires a direct position on “Evaluate the proposition that backward-class policy in India has solved identification but...”, every clause, constitutional/statutory/policy distinction, rights-holder and institution map, eligibility/exclusion and delivery chain, intersectional and regional variation, named Indian evidence, accountability and qualified conclusion.

Detailed examiner-grade model answer:

Introduction and thesis: Identification and distribution are different problems with different instruments, so the evaluation must show that the list-making route is settled while the division of the quota inside the category is not, and must close with a graded verdict that is honest about the missing evidence.

Analytical body:

1. **Claim and named evidence:** For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.
2. **Claim and named evidence:** State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed. **Analysis:** Connect right or

deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

3. **Claim and named evidence:** Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

4. **Claim and named evidence:** The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome. **Analysis:** Connect right or deprivation -> institutional duty and eligibility rule -> frontline implementation -> differentiated access and outcome -> grievance, audit or course correction. **Qualification:** State internal group and regional variation, legal/operative status, denominator, fiscal or causal limit, accessibility, dignity, privacy, portability or residual exclusion.

Counter-position / limit: A constitutional promise, prohibition, reservation provision, scheme catalogue, allocation, registration count or headline statistic cannot alone establish accessible implementation, adequate benefit, dignity, remedy or attributable outcome; test eligibility, institutions, frontline capacity, intersectionality, regional variation, grievance and evidence status.

Qualified conclusion: Identification and distribution are different problems with different instruments, so the evaluation must show that the list-making route is settled while the division of the quota inside the category is not, and must close with a graded verdict that is honest about the missing evidence.

Executable exam-length answer / compression plan: For 20 marks, spend one-sixth of the time decoding the directive and drawing right/need -> institution -> eligibility -> delivery -> outcome -> remedy; state a thesis; write four to seven claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification points; reserve the final minute for dignity, accessibility, portability, grievance, denominator, fiscal and causal limits.

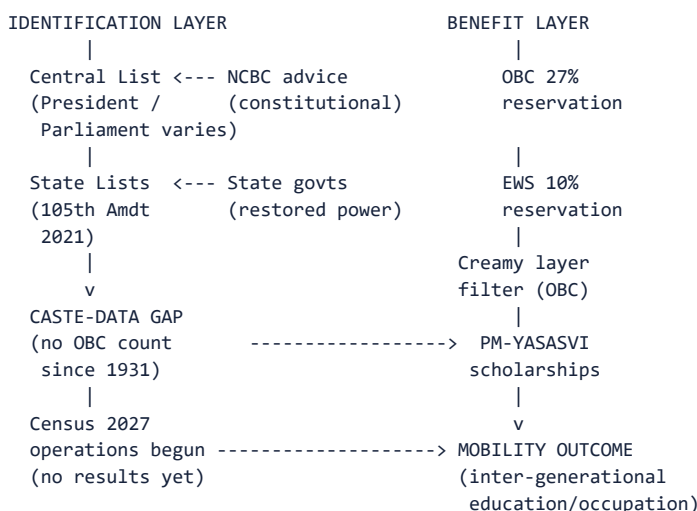
Why this earns marks: The answer obeys the directive, explains mechanisms rather than listing schemes, uses named India-centric evidence and preserves legal, institutional, group, eligibility, implementation, fiscal, data and outcome distinctions.

How to improve this answer: For “Evaluate the proposition that backward-class policy in India has solved identification but...”, replace the weakest scheme-catalogue point with one named rights-holder, duty-bearer, eligibility bottleneck, safeguard, grievance route, process/outcome indicator and source-status qualification.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Subject: Social Justice | **Tier:** Advanced | **GS Paper:** GS-II; cross-cuts GS-I (social stratification, mobility) and GS-III (inclusive development). **Core area:** Other Backward Classes, Economically Weaker Sections, creamy layer, sub-categorisation, social mobility measurement, caste-data gap. **Grounded in:** Indra Sawhney v. Union of India (1992); Janhit Abhiyan v. Union of India (2022); 102nd, 103rd, 105th Constitutional Amendment Acts; Rohini Commission (2017); PM-YASASVI; SECC 2011 (unreleased OBC data); Census Act, 1948. **FACT:** = source-grounded | **ANALYSIS:** = inference/analysis | **CURRENT:** = current anchor. **Companion:** basic/09_OBC-EWS-and-Social-Mobility.md.

1. Architecture



Analytical claim: ANALYSIS: OBC policy operates with an identification paradox: reservation is premised on social-educational backwardness, but the absence of OBC population data since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, sub-categorisation and mobility tracking. The 2027 Census caste enumeration may resolve this paradox, but its policy operationalisation is not yet settled.

2. Concepts and distinctions

Concept	Precise meaning
FACT: Social-educational backwardness vs economic backwardness	OBC identification is based on social and educational backwardness (caste/community-based historical disadvantage), not solely income; EWS identification is based purely on economic criteria (income and asset thresholds) for non-SC/ST/OBC citizens - the two are conceptually and constitutionally distinct.
FACT: Creamy layer (status + income/wealth test)	The exclusion rule combines notified parental service/status categories with an income/wealth test where applicable. The Rs 8 lakh threshold applies over three consecutive years; salary income and agricultural-land income are not simply clubbed into it.
FACT: Sub-categorisation within OBCs	The proposal (examined by the Rohini Commission, 2017) to divide the 27% OBC quota among sub-groups to ensure equitable distribution and prevent concentration of benefits among a few dominant OBC communities.
ANALYSIS: Intergenerational mobility vs first-generation access	Reservation provides first-generation access (entry to education/employment); true mobility is measured by whether subsequent generations consolidate and advance - a distinction often conflated in policy discourse.
ANALYSIS: Caste-data gap	The last published all-caste census tables are from 1931; SECC 2011 collected caste data but it was not released/validated for general policy use. Caste enumeration is approved for Census 2027, but as at 21 July 2026 it has produced no results.

3. Detailed causal chain: identification to mobility

- Community identification:** A community's social-educational backwardness is assessed (traditionally by state backward-class commissions, now NCBC for central list) based on indicators such as caste-based occupation, literacy, representation in services, and social stigma.
- List inclusion:** Article 342A governs the Central List (President specifies; Parliament varies), with NCBC advice/consultation in the institutional process. States maintain separate lists for State purposes after the 105th Amendment.

3. **Creamy-layer filter:** An individual from a listed OBC community must obtain a non-creamy-layer certificate to claim reservation benefits, ensuring the economically/ socially advanced within the category do not capture benefits meant for the backward.
4. **Reservation uptake:** The individual accesses reserved seats in education or employment, gaining first-generation entry into higher education or government service.
5. **Welfare schemes:** PM-YASASVI provides notified education-support routes for OBC/EBC/DNT students, complementing reservation. State/year-specific components must be checked before claiming a particular scholarship is open.
6. **First-generation to second-generation:** If the beneficiary's children achieve higher educational attainment and occupational status, intergenerational mobility is realised; if they merely re-access reservation without progression, mobility stagnates.
7. **Policy feedback (currently constrained):** Without published OBC population data, cannot assess: (a) whether reservation proportions match population proportions, (b) which sub-groups within OBCs are benefiting, (c) mobility outcomes over cohorts.

4. Institutional and reform architecture

- FACT: **NCBC (constitutional body, post-2018):** Examines inclusion/exclusion requests, advises on backwardness criteria, monitors safeguards and handles complaints. It does not itself amend the Article 342A Central List.
- FACT: **Rohini Commission (2017):** Set up to examine sub-categorisation of OBCs within the 27% quota - the commission's report would enable equitable distribution among OBC sub-groups, but implementation remains pending as of mid-2026.
- FACT: **EWS income/asset criteria:** Defined by a DoPT notification dated 31 January 2019: gross annual family income below Rs 8 lakh, and family must not own 5 acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere. These figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were upheld by the Supreme Court in November 2022 (Janhit Abhiyan).
- ANALYSIS: **EWS certificate verification challenge:** Unlike caste certificates (linked to hereditary community identity), EWS certificates require income verification - a harder administrative task, leading to concerns about fake certificates and exclusion of genuinely poor applicants lacking documentation.

5. Indian applications and boundary cases

- ANALYSIS: A dominant OBC community in a state may capture a disproportionate share of OBC reservation seats, leaving numerically smaller or more backward OBC communities under-represented - the rationale for sub-categorisation.
- ANALYSIS: An EWS applicant with undocumented informal-sector income may fail to obtain a certificate despite genuine economic weakness, or conversely, an applicant with concealed income may fraudulently obtain one - the identification gap.
- ANALYSIS: The Janhit Abhiyan majority (3-2) upheld EWS reservation on the ground that economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that exceeding 50% ceiling does not violate basic structure when the addition is for a new category (not within existing SC/ST/OBC); the dissent argued economic criterion cannot exclude existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality.

6. Limitations and trade-offs

- ANALYSIS: **Creamy-layer threshold lag:** The income ceiling is revised periodically but often lags behind inflation, leading to either over-inclusion (ceiling too high) or under-inclusion (ceiling too low) of genuinely backward OBC applicants.
- ANALYSIS: **EWS excludes SC/ST/OBC:** By definition, EWS reservation is for non-SC/ST/OBC

citizens; an economically poor SC/ST/OBC individual is not eligible for EWS but may already have access to their respective reservation - the design is intentional but generates criticism that economic backwardness within reserved categories is ignored.

- ANALYSIS: **Data blindness:** Without published OBC population data, sub-categorisation is politically contested and technically difficult. Census 2027 operations have begun, but its results, validation and policy use are not yet available.

- ANALYSIS: **Mobility vs coverage:** Policy discourse focuses on reservation-slot fill rates and scholarship disbursement, not on whether beneficiaries achieve intergenerational mobility - a measurement gap.

7. Must-Know Facts for Advanced Prelims

- FACT: Indra Sawhney v. Union of India (1992) upheld OBC reservation up to 27% and mandated creamy-layer exclusion for OBCs (not SC/ST).

- FACT: The 102nd Constitutional Amendment (2018) made NCBC a constitutional body but was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case as removing states' power to prepare OBC lists - the 105th Amendment (2021) corrected this.

- FACT: The 103rd Constitutional Amendment (2019) enabled EWS reservation; Janhit Abhiyan v. Union of India (November 2022) upheld it by a 3-2 majority.

- FACT: The SECC 2011 collected caste data, but the OBC data was never officially released or validated for policy use.

- FACT: The OBC income/wealth ceiling (Rs 8 lakh, since September 2017) and EWS income ceiling (Rs 8 lakh, since January 2019) are numerically identical but legally different: the former includes parental service/status categories and income exclusions; the latter also has notified asset limits.

8. Advanced Prelims traps

- WRONG: The 102nd Amendment gave states the power to prepare their own OBC lists. -> FACT: The 102nd Amendment was interpreted as centralising list-making power with Parliament; the 105th Amendment (2021) explicitly restored states' power for state-level lists.

- WRONG: Sub-categorisation of OBCs has been implemented nationally. -> FACT: Sub-categorisation is under examination (Rohini Commission, 2017); implementation remains pending as of mid-2026.

- WRONG: EWS reservation is available to economically poor OBCs. -> FACT: EWS reservation under the 103rd Amendment explicitly excludes SC/ST/OBC; it is for non-reserved category citizens meeting economic criteria only.

9. CURRENT: Current-anchor note

- CURRENT: **Census 2027 status (21 July 2026):** CCPA's 30 April 2025 decision includes caste enumeration. First-phase houselisting is notified for 1 April-30 September 2026 in an all-digital Census. It is not a published dataset and cannot yet validate a sub-categorisation formula or revise a list.

- FACT: The OBC income/wealth ceiling is Rs 8 lakh (September 2017), but it is not the same test as the EWS Rs 8 lakh-plus-asset criterion. State the parental status and income exclusions before drawing a comparison.

10. PYQ-based analytical application

- ANALYSIS: There is no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 GS-II Mains PYQ specifically on OBC/EWS in the audited local PYQ texts. A strong Mains answer should: (a) distinguish social-educational backwardness (OBC) from economic backwardness (EWS), (b) explain the creamy-layer rationale and its limitations, (c) cite Janhit Abhiyan (2022) for EWS constitutional validity, (d) note the caste-data gap and the 2027 Census decision, and (e) frame reservation as a means to social mobility, not an end in itself.

11. Mains-ready framework

Central thesis: OBC reservation addresses caste-based social-educational backwardness with a creamy-layer filter to ensure intra-group equity, while EWS reservation addresses pure economic disadvantage among non-reserved categories; both suffer from an identification-to-outcome gap - OBC policy lacks population data for calibration, EWS policy faces income-verification challenges - and their success must be measured by intergenerational social mobility, not coverage statistics alone.

1. **Define the category and its constitutional basis:** OBC under Art 15(4)/16(4), EWS under Art 15(6)/16(6) (103rd Amendment, 2019).
2. **Explain the identification mechanism:** Article 342A's President/Parliament route for the Central List; state governments for State lists (105th Amendment); income/ asset verification for an EWS certificate.
3. **Distinguish the filter:** creamy layer for OBC (parental status plus applicable income/wealth test) versus the EWS income/asset threshold - different mechanisms, different rationales.
4. **Flag the data gap:** no published OBC population dataset; SECC 2011 data unreleased; Census 2027 enumeration approved and operations begun, but no results or validated policy dataset exists.
5. **Link to outcome:** Reservation provides first-generation access; social mobility is measured by second-generation progression - policy should track mobility, not merely coverage.
6. **Recommend:** Sub-categorisation (for intra-OBC equity), robust EWS verification, mobility tracking using 2027 Census data once available.

12. Probable questions

- ANALYSIS: **Prelims:** Which commission was set up in 2017 to examine sub-categorisation of OBCs within the 27% reservation quota?
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (10 marks):** Explain the rationale for the creamy-layer exclusion in OBC reservation and discuss its limitations.
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks):** "The caste-data gap undermines evidence-based backward-class policy." Critically analyse this statement in light of the 2027 Census caste- enumeration decision.
- ANALYSIS: **Mains (15 marks):** Distinguish OBC reservation from EWS reservation with reference to their constitutional basis, identification criteria, and judicial pronouncements. How do they together advance social justice?

13. Study links

- FACT: Foundation companion: [basic/09_OBC-EWS-and-Social-Mobility.md](#).
- FACT: Polity/advanced/22_Special-Provisions.md - reservation doctrine, 103rd Amendment validity (Janhit Abhiyan), 50% ceiling jurisprudence.
- FACT: Polity/advanced/31_National-Commissions-SC-ST-BC.md - NCBC constitutional status, composition and mandate.
- FACT: [basic/07_Scheduled-Castes-Rights-Atrocities-and-Welfare.md](#) - SC reservation and welfare architecture, for comparison with OBC/EWS targeting.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

OBC, EWS and Social Mobility: RAPID RIGHT, SCHEME AND MEASURED-OUTCOME MAP

- 1. What this owner holds and why its previous-year record is stated as zero:** This owner holds the backward-class half of the affirmative-action argument: the identification of socially and educationally backward classes for the Central and State lists, the creamy-layer filter that runs inside the other backward classes, the separate economically weaker sections category created in 2019, the education-support framework for backward-class students, the sub-categorisation debate and the caste-data gap that constrains all of them; its distinctive feature is that the audited routing ledgers route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to it for the covered years, so the zero is stated openly here, and the two neighbouring commission demands, the 2018 General Studies Paper II question on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions and the 2022 General Studies Paper II question on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status, are both routed by the audited 2018-2023 Mains ledger to the Polity commissions owner and are therefore not claimed here.
- 2. The constitutional and statutory bank for a backward-class answer:** The owners record the law bank precisely: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) permit special provision and reservation for socially and educationally backward classes, Article 342A governs the Central List of socially and educationally backward classes, Article 338B carries the national commission for those classes after the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018, and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6), inserted by the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019, enable reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections; the statutory layer is the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, which was repealed once the commission was given constitutional status, and the answer-writing discipline is that the backward-class route and the economic-criterion route are two constitutionally distinct routes and must never be merged into one reservation story.
- 3. The Central List route under Article 342A:** For central purposes the Constitution routes list-making through Article 342A, under which the President specifies the socially and educationally backward classes and Parliament alone may include a community in or exclude a community from that list, while the national commission examines inclusion and exclusion requests, advises on the criteria of backwardness, monitors safeguards and handles complaints; the examinable consequence is that the commission is a recommending and advisory institution inside the list-making process rather than an authority that can itself add a community, so a candidate who writes that the commission added a caste to the Central List has confused advice with legislation.
- 4. State lists and the restoration effected by the 105th Amendment:** State governments maintain their own lists of backward classes for State-level reservation, and the owners record the sequence that produced the present position: the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 was interpreted by the Supreme Court in the Maratha reservation case in 2021 as centralising list-making power in Parliament, and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021 then clarified that the President's list binds only central purposes and expressly restored the power of States to prepare their own lists of socially and educationally backward classes for State purposes; the discipline is that the 102nd Amendment did not grant that State power and the 105th Amendment did not create the category, it restored a competence that a judicial reading had removed.
- 5. The commission's own account of its constitutional status:** The National Commission for Backward Classes page on its own official website, read on 2 September 2026, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 was repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; and that the present eighth commission was accorded constitutional status and constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, the commission consisting of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018; nothing beyond those recorded statements is claimed, and no case, complaint, recommendation or list-revision count is asserted.
- 6. The creamy layer is a status test before it is an income test:** The owners define the creamy-layer exclusion as a rule resting primarily on the notified parental service and status categories, with an income and wealth test

applying where relevant at the notified ceiling of eight lakh rupees measured over three consecutive years, and they add the exclusion that salary income and income from agricultural land are not simply clubbed into that test; the reason the composition of the rule matters is that a candidate who compresses it into the single sentence that a family income above Rs 8 lakh disqualifies an applicant has stated neither the parental status limb nor the income exclusions, and will therefore misread every close option built on the difference between a status ground and an income ground.

7. **Creamy layer is confined to the other backward classes:** The owners state without qualification that the creamy-layer exclusion applies to reservation for the other backward classes and does not apply to reservation for the Scheduled Castes and the Scheduled Tribes, and they attribute that position to the decision in *Indra Sawhney* against Union of India and the jurisprudence that followed it; the trap this fact defuses is the very common transfer of an other-backward-class filter to a Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe answer, and the corresponding trap in the opposite direction, which is to assume that because a category is listed it must carry the same internal filter as every other listed category.
8. **What *Indra Sawhney* decided in 1992:** *Indra Sawhney* against Union of India, decided in 1992, upheld reservation of twenty-seven per cent for the other backward classes in central services and central educational institutions, mandated the creamy-layer exclusion within that category and laid down the ordinary ceiling of fifty per cent on total reservation, and the owners route the detailed constitutional doctrine to the Polity special-provisions owner rather than re-teaching it here; the analytical use of the judgment in a social-justice answer is that it fixed the two features which every later argument turns on, namely a quota expressed as a percentage and an internal equity filter, so any proposal about distribution has to be tested against both.
9. **The economically weaker sections category and the 103rd Amendment:** The Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserted Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) and enabled reservation of up to ten per cent in education and public employment for economically weaker citizens who do not fall within the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes or the other backward classes, and the owners insist on the exclusion as part of the definition rather than as a side condition; the consequence for an answer is that the category is defined negatively as well as economically, so an economically poor member of a reserved category is outside it by design, and the criticism that economic backwardness inside the reserved categories is ignored is a criticism of that deliberate design and not evidence of an administrative failure.
10. **The notified income and asset criteria for that category:** The owners record that the criteria were defined by a Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019, under which the gross annual family income must be below eight lakh rupees and the family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more, a residential plot of 100 sq yards or more in a notified municipality, or 200 sq yards or more elsewhere; the owners add that these figures have remained unchanged since 2019 and were before the Supreme Court when the amendment was upheld in November 2022, and the discipline is to quote the asset limits together with the income limit, because an answer that cites only the income figure has described half of a two-limbed test.
11. **Janhit Abhiyan in November 2022 and the shape of the disagreement:** *Janhit Abhiyan* against Union of India, decided in November 2022 by a majority of three to two, upheld the economically weaker sections reservation, the majority reasoning that an economic criterion alone can be a basis for affirmative action and that going beyond the fifty per cent ceiling does not violate the basic structure when the addition creates a new category rather than enlarging the existing reserved categories, while the dissent argued that an economic criterion cannot be used to exclude the existing reserved categories from a new benefit without violating substantive equality; the owners require both limbs to be stated, because reciting only the outcome converts a closely divided constitutional argument into a settled consensus.
12. **Why two identical rupee figures are two different legal tests:** The owners flag the single most productive close-option trap in this topic: the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling for the other backward classes stands at eight lakh rupees and has done so since a Department of Personnel and Training notification of September 2017, and the economically weaker sections income ceiling also stands at eight lakh rupees since January 2019, yet the two are legally different tests, because the first sits on top of notified parental service and status categories and carries income exclusions for salary and agricultural land, while the second is a gross annual family income test paired with notified asset limits; identical arithmetic therefore proves nothing about identical eligibility, and an answer must say which test it is applying.

13. **The umbrella education-support framework for backward-class students:** The owners record the umbrella support framework of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students belonging to the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes, known as PM-YASASVI, whose notified routes include pre-matric and post-matric support and a top-class education route, and they attach two disciplines: the applicable annual guideline decides which component is actually open in which State and year, so no component may be assumed to be universally available, and the economically backward classes served by this framework are not interchangeable with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route created by amendment.
14. **Sub-categorisation and the commission that examined it:** Sub-categorisation is the proposal to divide the twenty-seven per cent quota for the other backward classes among sub-groups so that the benefit is not concentrated in a few relatively advanced communities, and the owners record that the Rohini Commission was set up in 2017 to examine it and that implementation remained pending as of mid-2026; the owners also record why the question is hard rather than merely political, namely that a defensible division requires backwardness and representation data for each sub-group, so the measure that would correct unequal distribution depends on precisely the evidence that the caste-data gap withholds.
15. **The caste-data gap and what the 2011 socio-economic survey did not settle:** The owners record that the last published all-caste census tables are from 1931 and that the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011 collected caste data which was never officially released or validated for general policy use, and they draw the consequence explicitly: without a published population dataset it is not possible to say whether reservation proportions match population proportions, which sub-groups within the category are actually benefiting, or how outcomes move across cohorts; the discipline for an answer is that this is an evidence gap and not a claim about the size of any community, so no share, count or proportion for the other backward classes may be asserted from it.
16. **The 2027 enumeration decision and its exact status:** The owners carry the status of the enumeration decision with unusual care as at 21 July 2026: the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 that caste enumeration will be included, the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise, and the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026; the owners then state the boundary, which is that this is an approved and ongoing operation and not published caste data, not a completed methodology and not an automatic basis for revising any list or validating any sub-categorisation formula, so an answer may use the decision as a forthcoming evidence source and must not use it as evidence.
17. **Certificate verification as the administrative weak point of an income-based category:** The owners record that an applicant claiming reservation for the other backward classes must obtain a certificate verifying that the family does not fall within the creamy-layer exclusion, while an applicant for the economically weaker sections category must obtain a certificate from the State or Union Territory authority attesting income and assets, and they identify the second as the harder administrative task because a caste certificate attaches to a hereditary community identity whereas an income certificate must value a flow that is often informal and undocumented; the two recorded failure modes are exclusion of a genuinely poor applicant who cannot document income and fraudulent inclusion of an applicant who conceals it.
18. **Coverage, first-generation access and intergenerational mobility:** The owners separate three things that policy discourse routinely merges: coverage, which counts reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed; first-generation access, which is what reservation actually delivers, namely entry into higher education or public service for the first member of a family to reach it; and intergenerational mobility, which is realised only if the next generation achieves higher educational attainment and occupational status than the beneficiary, and which stagnates if the children merely re-access the same reservation without progression; the answer-writing consequence is that a recommendation must state which of the three it improves, because an entry instrument does not by itself produce a mobility outcome.
19. **The identification paradox that constrains policy feedback:** The owners state the analytical core of the topic as an identification paradox: reservation for the other backward classes is premised on social and educational backwardness, yet the absence of a published population dataset since 1931 prevents evidence-based calibration of beneficiary proportions, evidence-based sub-categorisation and any cohort-level tracking of mobility, so the policy operates without the feedback loop that would tell it whether it is working; the owners are careful that this is

a claim about the evidence base and not a claim that the policy has failed, and an answer should use it to argue for measurement design rather than to assert an outcome that the data cannot support.

20. **The transparent ownership statement for this owner:** The audited routing ledgers, which cover the Mains papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025 and the Prelims papers for 2018 to 2023 and 2024 to 2025, route no General Studies Mains demand and no objective demand to this owner, and both the Basic and the Advanced owner state independently that no confirmed direct 2024 or 2025 General Studies Paper II Mains question on this subject matter exists in the audited local texts, which is consistent with that zero; the 2022 General Studies Paper II demand on the backward-class commission moving from statutory to constitutional status is routed to the Polity commissions owner and the 2018 General Studies Paper II demand on the Scheduled Caste commission and reservation in minority institutions is routed there as well, so neither is claimed here, and the practice in this package is therefore six original Mains questions with model solutions written to the repository's examiner-grade standard together with eighty original objective questions on a strict A -> B -> C -> D rotation.

OBC, EWS and Social Mobility: CLOSE-OPTION AND ENTITLEMENT TRAPS

- Do not merge the backward-class route with the economic-criterion route, because Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) and Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) are constitutionally distinct enabling provisions.
- Do not say the national commission for backward classes can itself add a community to the Central List, because Article 342A gives that power to the President and Parliament and leaves the commission an examining and advisory role.
- Do not credit the 102nd Amendment with restoring the State power to prepare lists, because the 105th Amendment did that after a judicial reading had removed it.
- Do not call the present commission a statutory body, because its own official page records that it was accorded constitutional status through the 102nd Amendment and that the 1993 Act was repealed in 2018.
- Do not describe the creamy layer as a simple gross-family-income limit, because it rests on notified parental service and status categories and excludes salary and agricultural-land income from the income test.
- Do not apply the creamy-layer exclusion to Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe reservation, because it is confined to the other backward classes.
- Do not state the 1992 judgment as if it created only a percentage, because it also mandated the creamy-layer exclusion and laid down the ordinary fifty per cent ceiling.
- Do not describe the economically weaker sections category as covering economically poor members of the reserved categories, because the definition expressly excludes the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes and the other backward classes.
- Do not quote the economically weaker sections income limit without its asset limits, because the notified test also turns on agricultural land, residential flat area and residential plot area.
- Do not present the 2022 decision as unanimous, because it was a three-to-two majority and the dissent rested on substantive equality.
- Do not treat the two Rs 8 lakh figures as one test, because the creamy-layer ceiling and the economically weaker sections ceiling are legally different instruments with different limbs.
- Do not equate the economically backward classes served by the education-support framework with the constitutional economically weaker sections category, because one is a scheme classification and the other is a constitutional route.
- Do not assume any component of the education-support framework is open in every State and year, because the applicable annual guideline decides that.
- Do not state that sub-categorisation has been implemented, because the examining commission of 2017 reported into a process whose implementation remained pending as of mid-2026.
- Do not assert any population share for the other backward classes, because the last published all-caste tables are from 1931 and the 2011 socio-economic and caste data were never released or validated for policy use.
- Do not treat the 2027 enumeration decision as data, because it is an approved and ongoing operation whose first-phase houselisting window ran from 1 April to 30 September 2026 and which has produced no published caste dataset.

- Do not describe an income certificate as administratively equivalent to a caste certificate, because one attests a hereditary community identity and the other must value an often informal and undocumented flow.
- Do not read coverage as mobility, because slots filled and scholarships disbursed measure entry and not intergenerational progression.
- Do not convert the identification paradox into a verdict of policy failure, because it is a statement about the missing evidence base and not about the outcome.
- Do not manufacture a previous-year demand card for this owner, because the audited ledgers route no Mains and no objective demand here and route the two commission demands to the Polity owner.

OBC, EWS and Social Mobility: ANSWER-WRITING SPINE

NAME THE DEPRIVATION OR CLAIM -> IDENTIFY THE RIGHT-HOLDER AND THE DUTY-BEARER
 -> SEPARATE THE CONSTITUTIONAL OR STATUTORY ENTITLEMENT FROM THE SCHEME THAT CARRIES IT
 -> TRACE ADMINISTRATIVE DELIVERY: IDENTIFICATION, ENROLMENT, ACCESS, QUALITY
 -> TEST THE MEASURED OUTCOME AGAINST THE INPUT, NAMING SURVEY, ROUND AND YEAR
 -> SEPARATE INCLUSION ERROR FROM EXCLUSION ERROR AND COVERAGE FROM CAPABILITY
 -> CLOSE WITH A GRADED VERDICT AND AN EXPLICIT INDICATOR OR STATUS CAVEAT

OBC, EWS and Social Mobility: DATED-INDICATOR AND STATUS BOUNDARY

One live official page was verified for this topic on 2026-09-02. The National Commission for Backward Classes About Us page on the commission's own website, read on that date, records that the commission was initially constituted by the central government under the National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993 dated 2 April 1993 and had so far been reconstituted seven times up to 2016; that the Act of 1993 has been repealed through the National Commission for Backward Classes (Repeal) Act, 2018 dated 14 August 2018; that the present eighth commission has been accorded constitutional status and was constituted through the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 dated 11 August 2018, whereby Article 338B was inserted, forming a commission for the socially and educationally backward classes to be known as the National Commission for Backward Classes; and that the commission consists of a Chairperson, a Vice-Chairperson and three other Members in the rank and pay of Secretary to the Government of India, whose conditions of service and tenure of office were notified by a Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment notification dated 23 August 2018. Those statements are used only for what they say, and no case, complaint, recommendation, sitting or list-revision figure is inferred from them. Four further official checks were attempted on the same date, namely a departmental scheme identifier that returned a not-found page, a second departmental scheme identifier that returned the same not-found page, a departmental scheme listing page that returned navigational content only and a departmental sector-information page that returned navigational content only, so nothing was read or used from them and no secondary summary, coaching site or news report has been treated as an official source. The package therefore relies on that verified page together with the dated official anchors already carried by the repository owners, each cited with its issuing instrument or decision date: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4) for special provision and reservation; Article 342A for the Central List, with the President specifying and Parliament alone varying it; Article 338B for the national commission; the Constitution (One Hundred and Second Amendment) Act, 2018 and the Constitution (One Hundred and Fifth Amendment) Act, 2021, the second of which restored the power of States to prepare their own lists for State purposes after the 2021 Maratha reservation reading; the Constitution (One Hundred and Third Amendment) Act, 2019 inserting Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) for reservation of up to ten per cent for economically weaker sections outside the Scheduled Castes, the Scheduled Tribes and the other backward classes; the decision in Indra Sawhney against Union of India of 1992 upholding twenty-seven per cent reservation, mandating the creamy-layer exclusion for the other backward classes only and stating the ordinary fifty per cent ceiling; the creamy-layer income and wealth ceiling of eight lakh rupees notified in September 2017, applied over three consecutive years on top of notified parental service and status categories and with salary and agricultural-land income excluded from simple clubbing; the Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019 setting a gross annual family income below eight lakh rupees together with the asset limits of five acres of agricultural land, a residential flat of 1,000 sq ft, a residential plot of 100 sq yards in a notified municipality and 200 sq yards elsewhere; the decision in Janhit Abhiyan against Union of India of November 2022 upholding that reservation by a majority of three to two, with the recorded majority reasoning and the recorded dissent; the umbrella education-support framework PM-YASASVI of the Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment for students of the other backward classes, the economically backward classes and the denotified, nomadic and semi-nomadic tribes; the Rohini Commission of 2017 examining sub-categorisation, with implementation recorded as

pending as of mid-2026; the last published all-caste census tables of 1931 and the unreleased and unvalidated caste data of the Socio Economic and Caste Census of 2011; and the recorded status as at 21 July 2026 that the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs decided on 30 April 2025 to include caste enumeration, that the 2027 Census is planned as an all-digital exercise and that the first-phase houselisting window was notified for 1 April to 30 September 2026. No population share, beneficiary count, certificate count, seat-fill rate, scholarship disbursement, budget or expenditure figure is asserted, no National Family Health Survey, Periodic Labour Force Survey, National Sample Survey, NITI Aayog or Sustainable Development Goal value is asserted, no legal or constitutional provision is invented or upgraded in status, no judicial observation is converted into a binding holding or a legislated rule, no pending report or bill is described as enacted or implemented, and no previous-year question, official answer key or option is asserted or inferred.

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/12: Two routes, two logics

DISADVANTAGE -> social and educational backwardness OR pure economic weakness
-> ROUTE A: Article 15(4) and Article 16(4); listed classes; 27 per cent; creamy-layer filter
-> ROUTE B: Article 15(6) and Article 16(6); up to 10 per cent; excludes SC, ST and OBC
-> EVIDENCE A: community backwardness; EVIDENCE B: notified income and asset test
TEST -> neither route supplies the other route's evidence or its filter
MUST REMEMBER: OBC, EWS and social mobility analysis separates social and educational...

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/12: Law bank

ARTICLE 15(4) AND 16(4) -> special provision and reservation for backward classes
ARTICLE 342A -> Central List; President specifies; Parliament alone includes or excludes
ARTICLE 338B -> the national commission for backward classes, inserted in 2018
ARTICLE 15(6) AND 16(6) -> economically weaker sections, inserted in 2019
STATUTE -> National Commission for Backward Classes Act, 1993, later repealed

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/12: List-making ladder

STEP 1 -> community backwardness examined against social and educational indicators
STEP 2 -> commission examines inclusion or exclusion requests and advises
STEP 3 -> President specifies the Central List under Article 342A
STEP 4 -> Parliament alone varies that list by including or excluding a community
PARALLEL -> States prepare their own lists for State purposes after the 105th Amendment

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/12: Commission status card

CONSTITUTED -> under the Act of 1993 dated 2 April 1993; reconstituted seven times to 2016
REPEALED -> the 1993 Act, through the Repeal Act of 2018 dated 14 August 2018
ELEVATED -> eighth commission, 102nd Amendment dated 11 August 2018, Article 338B inserted
COMPOSITION -> Chairperson, Vice-Chairperson and three other Members
RANK -> Secretary to the Government of India; conditions notified on 23 August 2018

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/12: Creamy-layer test

LIMB 1 STATUS -> notified parental service and status categories exclude the applicant
LIMB 2 INCOME -> ceiling of ₹8 lakh applied over three consecutive years
EXCLUSIONS -> salary income and agricultural-land income are not simply clubbed in
SCOPE -> the filter runs inside the other backward classes only
ERROR -> transferring the filter to Scheduled Caste or Scheduled Tribe reservation

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/12: Amendment and judgment sequence

1992 -> Indra Sawhney upholds 27 per cent, mandates creamy layer, states the 50 per cent ceiling
2018 -> 102nd Amendment inserts Article 338B and Article 342A; the 1993 Act is repealed
2019 -> 103rd Amendment inserts Article 15(6) and Article 16(6) for economic weakness
2021 -> Maratha reservation reading centralises list-making; 105th Amendment restores States
2022 -> Janhit Abhiyan upholds the economic criterion by a majority of three to two

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/12: Economic-criterion card

NOTIFIED -> Department of Personnel and Training notification dated 31 January 2019
INCOME -> gross annual family income below ₹8 lakh
LAND -> family must not own five acres or more of agricultural land
BUILT -> no residential flat of 1,000 sq ft or more
PLOT -> no plot of 100 sq yards in a notified municipality or 200 sq yards elsewhere

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/12: Same figure, different test

CREAMY LAYER -> ₹8 lakh since September 2017; three consecutive years
PLUS -> notified parental service and status categories; salary and land income excluded
ECONOMIC CRITERION -> ₹8 lakh since January 2019; gross annual family income
PLUS -> notified land, flat and plot asset limits, unchanged since 2019
RULE -> identical arithmetic proves nothing about identical eligibility

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/12: Judgment split

HELD -> reservation for economically weaker sections is constitutionally valid
MAJORITY -> an economic criterion alone can ground affirmative action
MAJORITY -> exceeding the ceiling for a new category does not breach the basic structure
DISSENT -> excluding the reserved categories from a new benefit denies substantive equality
MARGIN -> three to two, so the disagreement is part of the holding's meaning

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/12: Distribution problem

QUOTA -> 27 per cent for the other backward classes as a single undivided block
OBSERVED -> concentration of benefit in relatively advanced communities within the block
PROPOSAL -> sub-categorisation of the quota among sub-groups
EXAMINED BY -> the commission set up in 2017; implementation pending as of mid-2026
REQUIREMENT -> backwardness and representation data for each sub-group
CLOSE DISTINCTION: OBC is not a synonym for poverty, EWS is not an OBC sub-category,...

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/12: Data gap

LAST PUBLISHED ALL-CASTE TABLES -> 1931

SOCIO-ECONOMIC AND CASTE CENSUS 2011 -> caste data never released or validated for policy

DECISION -> Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs, 30 April 2025, to enumerate caste

OPERATION -> all-digital 2027 Census; houselisting notified 1 April to 30 September 2026

BOUNDARY -> an approved operation is not a published dataset and validates no formula

EVIDENCE LIMIT: AUTHORITY / IMPLEMENTATION: Use Articles 15, 16 and 342A, NCBC, list...

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/12: Entry against conversion

COVERAGE -> reservation slots filled and scholarships disbursed in a reporting year

FIRST-GENERATION ACCESS -> the first family member reaching higher education or service

MOBILITY -> the next generation exceeding the beneficiary in education and occupation

STAGNATION -> children re-accessing the same reservation without progression

OWNERSHIP -> no Mains or objective demand is routed here and none is manufactured